

# **CONFERENCE '72**

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**Twenty-Second  
Annual Meeting  
of the  
General Service  
Conference  
of  
Alcoholics Anonymous**

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**Hotel Roosevelt  
New York  
April 17-22, 1972**

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## *“Our Primary Purpose”*

— Conference Theme

An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is “confidential” only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The “confidential” designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

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# 'We Are Here to Learn — and to Share'

Guided by the Conference theme, "Our Primary Purpose," delegates to the 22nd North American General Service Conference joined with their fellow conferees in obtaining the group conscience on a number of questions, many having to do with improving communications and other questions requiring clarification and discussion in light of our Traditions.

Ninety delegates attended the week-long sessions, April 17-22, at the Hotel Roosevelt, together with the trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine staffs and directors, plus a limited number of nonvoting observers from some of the Board Committees and other people having special assignments at the Conference.

Dr. Norris, chairman of the General Service Board, welcomed the delegates and other Conference members, and said: "This Conference is a sharing of our experience, strength and hope, a sharing of our concerns of the things that are happening all over North America which may influence A.A. and create problems for us, changes which will make it much more important to work with other people working with alcoholics than it was even five years ago. One of my privileges and advantages is that I can remember what the alcoholism picture used to be and perhaps not react with quite as much concern to the things that are happening now. This has helped greatly to keep things in perspective.

"For all of you this Conference will be a part of the increasing strength of the movement. Those of you who have studied the Third Legacy know how much Bill depended on the Conference for the continuing strength and growth of the Fellowship. He saw it as a part of the tradition that will keep A.A. alive and strong—and it now is our responsibility.

"A real part of the strength of the group conscience is our own integrity, enabling us to meet any of the stresses and strains that work on and through us.

"A rewarding part of my experience in A.A. has been to see the group con-

## IN MEMORIAM

**Hazel R.**, G.S.O. staff member 16 years, died Sept. 10, 1971, at Southport, Conn.

**Betty R.**, delegate Panel 21, No. Carolina, died Oct. 3, 1971.

**Walter H.**, delegate Panel 20, Tennessee, died July 1971.

science at work. I have learned to trust and to depend upon it."

Bob McA., chairman of the "Delegates Only" meeting, also greeted the Conference members at the opening session, reminding them that "We have got a lot of work cut out for us this week. But it will be an unforgettable experience: to learn all that we can and then to share what we have learned—

that is why we are here, to learn and to share.

A highlight of the opening day's activities is always the evening banquet, followed by a regular A.A. meeting. Spouses of delegates, trustees, directors and staffs are invited to attend on this occasion, the only such "togetherness" event of the entire week. Also invited are special guests—A.A.'s and nonalcoholic friends who have been associated with G.S.O. during the past year, or those whose interest has remained active and appreciated over the years. A very special guest, is our lovely Lois, Bill's wife and Al-Anon's first lady.

The A.A. meeting this year was chaired by the delegate from South-eastern New York, John R., who introduced the speakers, fellow delegates from Panel 21, Gloria C., Louisiana and Jim D., Oklahoma. They and John, shared their personal stories and A.A. experiences.

## Digest of Agenda

### Monday, April 17

Registration  
Welcome session and Keynote  
Area Delegate Chairman  
Meet Your G.S.O. Staff  
Request for Change of Region: Wisconsin  
Report: Chairman of the Board  
Trustees' and Conference Committee Chairmen  
Opening Dinner: A.A. Meeting

### Tuesday, April 18

A.A.W.S. Report  
International Events: Two Reports  
Presentation: World Directory, Part I  
Workshop: World Directory, Part I  
Conference and Trustees' Committee Meetings  
Unstructured Workshop

### Wednesday, April 19

Regional Trustee Election  
Responsibilities of Area Committees  
Tradition Seven at Work: Finance Presentation  
The Voice of the Conference  
Stepping Stones  
Bill Wilson Memorial Fund

### Thursday, April 20

Conference Committee Meetings  
Tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine Offices  
Delegates' Only Dinner and Meeting

### Friday, April 21

Conference Committee Reports  
Report Back on Workshops  
Delegates' Only Meeting Report

### Saturday, April 22

Closing Brunch  
Trip to Bedford Hills

\*\*\*\*\*

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear area delegates of Panel 22 report on A.A. in their areas. This year, emphasis was on their personal service stories.

"ASK-IT-BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at several sessions during the Conference.

# Informed Third Legacy Workers Needed

Our primary purpose, carrying the message, is the basic service that the Fellowship gives. Our Third Legacy of Service is expressed through a physical structure which comprises this Conference, the General Service Board, G.S.O. and its two service arms, A.A.W.S., Inc., and the Grapevine, Inc. and includes the areas, districts, and the groups—our lines of communication flow steadily in both directions along these paths. This beautifully designed structure should be efficient and productive; we have been operating it for more than 20 years, but it is not perfect because we who implement it are not perfect.

Perhaps we could use some part of this Conference to examine parts of our structure. I believe we have a lot to learn about ourselves. Bill continually addressed himself to the subject of leadership in A.A. He noted that "Students of history recognize that the transference of the original leadership of a society to its successors in leadership is always a critical turning point. This difficult question of leadership... must now be faced."

I'm sure that we shall survive and grow and continue to fulfill our responsibilities. But let us beware. Bill also said "With leadership we shall have a continuous problem... hence great care needs to be taken. In this area a degree of weakness tends to persist. It seems to be a matter of increased care and responsibility and education." That short statement opens up the whole field of General Service for earnest consideration.

## Need for dedicated service people

If we agree that this Conference needs and must have the best obtainable delegates, how can we assure that if we do not have the best available people as committee members and G.S.R.'s? If we could have an abundance of these knowledgeable and dedicated people, would it not strengthen and stimulate our groups?

We have some rather unsettling facts which we must face. Many of our own members do not know nor really seem concerned with what it means to be an A.A. member. Let's be honest and factual in evaluating ourselves. If we don't have these facts, let's get them; let's devise an "insider" survey and put it in the hands of our knowledgeable delegates, committee members and G.S.R.'s: Is it true that we have too many members with long sobriety who settle for the Twelve Steps and "practice the Traditions by accident"? How many members are familiar with the Third Legacy or with the story from whence we came, as it is set forth in "A.A. Comes of Age"? If we are aware of and enthusiastic about the Grapevine, why do less than 15% buy it?

I'm convinced that only a strong, knowledgeable and dedicated leadership comprised of members who are dedicated to the self-denying principles of service leadership will be sufficient to provide our Fellowship with the continuing kind of warranty against the needs that tomorrow demands of us.

I feel it is our duty as Third Legacy workers to pass along to those who come behind us the most meaningful example of

service that we are able to provide. In addition to a knowledgeable leadership, if we can plan and carry out the plan, we shall have an ever-improving and informed group conscience. There will be problems to be met, but none that cannot be met and solved with our shared experience and effort.

As Third Legacy people, we have a special message to carry and there are many ways in which our message can be made known inside and outside the Fellowship. Like other societies, A.A. has special needs, and those needs are not constant but ever-changing.

In the early days, the Jack Alexander article brought about a change in A.A.'s priorities of that day, as did the Traditions and later, the adoption of the Third Legacy.

When we undertook the Legacy of Service, a new set of actions and reactions and needs began to emerge. In our A.A. world today, what are our needs? And what are our priorities? Think of the changes that have taken place; changes in our G.S.O., in our delegates representation, in the trusteeship of our Board.

In our deliberations this week, let us consider three simple things: *first*—we need informed Third Legacy workers at every level of service, which means better leadership, a better job of training and educating—we have to do better ourselves. Service means putting other people first; we have the greatest "people first" program in the world—everything we have is based in sharing. "People first" is part of our Primary Purpose.

*Second*—our districts. These are the strength and backbone of our structure. It is in our district committees that our priorities should be suggested and shaped to meet our needs; our groups must choose the best G.S.R.'s; maybe our single greatest need is for dedicated committee members. District meetings are the training centers for service work. A well-planned district program will result in an improved group conscience, better sponsorship and a more active group life. Thus, our leaders must be chosen, educated and trained out of the ranks of our membership, in and through the whole breadth of A.A. and nurtured on the vine of our service structure. It is a prime responsibility. *Third*—our assemblies. If agendas are sent out early to districts, the discussion of problems can be thoroughly examined at district meetings, more can be accomplished and better reports made of the meetings.

In the pamphlet, "General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous," published more than 20 years ago, Bill said that our Third Legacy is that "least possible organization" which will maintain us in effectiveness and unity. Our General Service organization provides the means so that thousands need not continue to suffer or die because we have taken no forethought. We are invited to dream, to plan and work to ensure that A.A.'s service lines never become severed. Let us fulfill our Three Legacies ensuring that A.A.'s message will continue to reach the "millions who don't yet know."

—Tom G., Manitoba  
General Service Trustee, Canada

# How Contributions Serve the Fellowship

Last year, A.A. groups and members contributed \$498,800 toward that share of the General Service Office operating expenses devoted to servicing the groups. These are the expenses directly related to servicing the A.A. members and groups throughout the world. The other G.S.O. expenses are publishing expenses, fully covered by the net income from sales, and various General Service Board expenses, such as Public Information, Professional Relations, Films, World Service Meetings, Board meetings, etc., also paid for out of publishing net income.

For this report we would like to concentrate on the contribution dollar and such questions as: how much is spent per group, how is that being affected by inflation, are we operating as efficiently today as we were, say, ten years ago, how are contributions allocated for service expenses and so on.

As the Fellowship has grown year by year, the purchasing power of the dollar has declined. We are constantly doing what we can to cut basic costs so that inflation and the cost of more services to more groups will still leave us with a workable budget. As the following table shows, despite inflation, the cost per group has not gone through the ceiling. In fact, when we adjust to the 1960 dollar, the service cost per group has actually declined. In 1960, with 8,615 groups registered, the cost per group was \$28.25. Allowing for a 38% decrease in the value of a dollar since that time, the 1971 cost was actually down to \$18.22.

| Year | No. of Groups | Service Expense | Cost per Group | Value of 1960 Dollar | Adjusted Cost per Group |
|------|---------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1960 | 8,615         | \$243,350       | \$28.25        | \$1.00               | \$28.25                 |
| 1965 | 12,444        | 319,070         | 25.65          | .94                  | 24.11                   |
| 1970 | 16,459        | 491,520         | 29.86          | .68                  | 20.30                   |
| 1971 | 17,776        | 522,220         | 29.38          | .62                  | 18.22                   |

While the number of groups has more than doubled since 1960, efficiency has increased, too — and G.S.O. has been able to add many needed services and still keep within a practical budget.

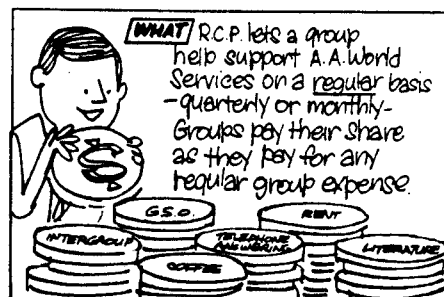
When expenditures are broken down by type of expense, a large share of the contribution dollar is allocated to three basic service expenses — salaries, service office printing and the expense of the Conference. Salaries, of course, are allocable to *all* service costs. This is one of the ways that your contributions are put to work. For example, the cost of printing and distributing the World Directory is budgeted at \$32,000 for 1972. However, when the cost of the labor required to produce the Directory is added, the total cost is closer to \$60,000. The same would hold true for the expense of the Conference. Budgeted at \$40,800, this expense also increases sharply when the share of the contribution dollar required to cover the cost of A.A. staff and clerical time is added to the overall cost.

Service expenses are incurred on a day to day basis, but our contribution receipts lag far behind for the first nine months of the year. Almost 40% of this year's contributions will not be received until the last three months of the year. In the mean-

time, we have to dip into fund capital to carry us along. If more groups would use the Regular Contribution Plan it would help make it possible for G.S.O. to service the Fellowship on a pay-as-you-go basis.

—Dennis Manders, Controller

## REGULAR CONTRIBUTION PLAN



## GRATITUDE DINNER CONTRIBUTION PLAN

Pat G., So. Florida, declared "If gratitude dinners were held throughout the country as they are here, our financial problems would no longer be problems." She went on: "These dinners, held in several Florida areas in November, enable us to contribute additional funds to the support of G.S.O."

"Ten years ago," she said, "members in Palm Beach County wanted to express their gratitude in a more substantial way than just in their prayers. . . then came the dinner idea. . . it spread to Broward County the next year, to Dade the following. The money is raised by members giving of themselves, their time, talents and other A.A.'s purchasing tickets at a very nominal sum (usually \$2.50) to enjoy a coffee hour, a good buffet dinner, hear a regular A.A. speaker, share a delightful evening, and at the same time, know this sharing has contributed to helping other A.A.'s throughout the world."



## PRESENTATION

# Is the World Directory Helping Us Carry the Message?

It has become increasingly apparent to us at G.S.O. that the *World Directory* is very limited in its usefulness. It would seem that the cost of \$23,500 is not commensurate with its present value as a tool to help us carry the message.

To help us evaluate the use of the Directory, a questionnaire was included in the 1971 holiday issue of *Box 4-5-9*. Over 600 replies were received.

As far as we can tell, the principal uses of the Directory are:

1. For travelers
2. As a mailing list for local conferences and conventions
3. As a Twelfth Step referral source.

It is not very useful as a Twelfth Step tool, however, since the names, addresses and telephone numbers cannot be used for referral to non-members (new prospects, families, agencies) without specific permission in each instance. Thus, it is often quite slow and difficult to get Twelfth Step contacts from the Directory for someone who wants to come to A.A., or for a nonalcoholic who wants to refer an alcoholic to A.A., since the proposed recipient of the call must be contacted and then give his permission. What we A.A.'s are aiming for is *immediate* help for the alcoholic. Some 513 answers to the questionnaire (out of the 600 received) confirmed the staff's thinking that the main use of the Directory is for travelers or people moving to new homes. Only 60 responded that it was used for Twelfth Step work.

When nonalcoholics who are working in the field of alcoholism (doctors, clergymen and others) write us asking for a Directory to help them make an A.A. contact, the present procedure is to write the appropriate delegate and wait for approval before we send it. This sometimes takes weeks. When we do receive a reply, the final decision is varied; sometimes the answer is "yes," sometimes "no." Though we assure the inquirer we'll do all we can to see that he is helped to get contacts, it's an awkward way to go about it. He often wants contacts outside his state and it makes it even more difficult for the delegate to help if he has decided that the Directory is not to be used. We have been criticized by non-A.A. professionals because we say we are eager to help the sick alcoholic and then seem to be dragging our feet in making ourselves available for Twelfth Step work.

### Problems at G.S.O.

In 1971, 8,273 inquiries were received by G.S.O. In many instances it is not possible to provide immediate help for the alcoholic. We can do this when there is a P.O. Box number, blind address or central office. Otherwise it is necessary to

write to the group, and we do not always know if there has been a follow-up.

When a newspaper story, magazine article or TV show on A.A., or on the general subject of alcoholism gives Box 459 as the address for those seeking further information, we receive hundreds of letters, some requesting only literature, but most wanting *help* for an alcoholic. Unless we have a P.O. Box number, a blind address or central office contact we can only suggest that they consult the local phone book. Many small towns have no local listing, in which case we suggest they ask local doctors, clergymen or policemen. This seems an inefficient procedure and not true to our stated purpose of extending our A.A. hand to the alcoholic who needs us.

We know our Directories are already in the hands of agencies where some workers are A.A. members. All that is necessary is for the employee to write us through his group or as an individual A.A., to receive the Directory with no difficulty, so our present elaborate system of protection for the Directory may be backfiring.

### What can be done?

To make the Directory more useful for Twelfth Step work we could agree that when cards are sent out, the names, telephone numbers and addresses that appear on them may be used for immediate contact.

—Ann M., G.S.O.

During the workshops to follow, it is hoped that delegates will discuss the following questions so that G.S.O. may follow the resulting recommendations.

1. Are we justified in spending approximately \$23,500 a year on the Directory when we are not able to use it for Twelfth Step work?
2. What would you think of requesting the groups to submit, for use in the Directory, only those names and phone numbers of A.A. members who are willing to have their names used as contacts?
3. If groups agree that the names listed in the 1973 Directory may be used for referral, would it be possible to make it available on request to agencies and facilities which work with alcoholics?
4. What is your feeling about G.S.O. providing the names that will appear in the 1973 Directory as immediate contacts for alcoholics in answer to letters and telephone inquiries?
5. If you feel that we are not justified in spending this much money just to be helpful to a comparatively small handful of travelers and to provide a mailing list, do you have specific suggestions to make it a more useful Twelfth Step tool?



# Guidelines Requested on Directory Use

As was suggested in the Presentation, the delegates discussed the proposed questions in nine workshops. A reporter, Shorty H., was assigned to summarize the answers to these questions, as follows:

**Q. Are we justified in spending approximately \$23,500 a year on the Directory when we aren't able to use it for Twelfth Step work?**

A. With the exception of three individual votes, all found the continuation of the Directory and the cost very worthwhile.

Among the suggestions was one that we list the names and phone numbers only; no addresses. Another, that the concentration of effort be directed toward A.A. and not toward other agencies.

**Q. What would you think of requesting the groups to submit, for use in the Directory, only those names and phone numbers of A.A. members who are willing to have their names used as contacts?**

A. Received a resounding "yes" with supplementary remarks that only those willing to take Twelfth Step calls be listed. It was remarked that perhaps a signature be requested on the Directory card after the name of the person who had agreed to be the Twelfth Step contact.

It was also suggested that the area delegate be responsible for the accuracy of the listings. An idea of having the Directory Card request, in addition to the G.S.R., full names, addresses and telephone number of members who would be willing to be used as contacts for anyone requesting A.A. help was submitted by one workshop.



Answering calls for help or information occur daily at G.S.O. —the World Directory should be our most useful referral source.

**Q. If groups agree that the names listed in the 1973 Directory may be used for referral, would it be possible to make it available on request to agencies and facilities which work with alcoholics?**

A. Various responses were received. In one instance where it was 10 to 2 in favor of making it available, it was specified that strong guidelines be adopted. One of the "yes" decisions stated that granting the Directory to outside agencies should be only done through the area delegate. In fact, three workshops stated this. One workshop felt that perhaps a separate Directory be compiled for outside agencies.

The indication was that the delegates prefer that the Directory not be distributed to outside agencies and that delegates continue to approve where it goes in their own areas. In other words that our present control methods be maintained.

**Q. What is your feeling about G.S.O. providing the names that will appear in the 1973 Directory as immediate contacts for alcoholics in answer to letters and telephone inquiries?**

A. One group stated they wanted G.S.O. to use names as they saw fit. As much as can be determined from the reports and conversations with the reporters, it seems they wish the names listed to be given to persons seeking help, but that the present practice be adhered to.

It was also suggested that the amounts of money contributed by individual groups be omitted.

**Q. If you feel that we are not justified in spending this much money just to be helpful to a comparatively small handful of travelers and to provide a mailing list, do you have specific suggestions to make it more useful as a 12th Step tool?**

A. There seemed to be no question that it is money well spent, but that clear guidelines be printed as to its use, that it be the responsibility of the delegate for the accuracy and also for the use of the Directory.

## Summary

What will possibly serve us best, would be a set of specific guidelines established from the vast experience of G.S.O. and approved by the delegates at some early date. However, to handle present needs, particularly at G.S.O., would each delegate present agree that his name may be used for any G.S.O. referral?

## Conference Action

It was recommended that a set of specific guidelines be prepared by G.S.O. on Directory use. Delegates unanimously agreed that their names may be used for any referrals from G.S.O.

# Responsibilities of Area Committees

## RESPONSIBILITIES OF AREA COMMITTEES SUGGESTED IN THE A.A. SERVICE MANUAL

With the growth of A.A. today, the importance of the area committee is vital to the unity and growth of our beloved Fellowship if A.A. as we know it is going to survive.

The A.A. Service Manual, under Area Committees, states: "The area committee, perhaps more than any other group of people in A.A., is responsible for the health of the Conference structure." How then can we, the trusted leaders of the area committee, insure the possibility of that statement being a reality?

As a result of our experience over the past several years, here are some measures we use in Eastern Pennsylvania: all newly elected committee members are asked to meet once a month with their G.S.R.'s to discuss group problems, read and discuss one of the Traditions, encourage G.S.R.'s to use available literature as helpful assets in solving group problems, and visit the groups in their districts.

To assure a better flow of communication between groups and the area committee, committee members meet every third month with the delegate and committee officers. There, an exchange of problems, solutions and ideas are discussed, bringing together the rural and metropolitan efforts of our districts.

Where there is an intergroup, a member of their steering committee is invited to attend, as an observer, any area meeting he wishes. Frequently, the delegate, past delegate or committee officers, are invited by the steering committee to sit in on their meeting for an exchange of ideas.

They are also willing, whenever asked, to go to any part of our area for rap sessions with members where serious problems may be affecting group harmony.

### Committee assists delegate

The area committee is also responsible for arranging meetings in all districts of Eastern Pennsylvania to assist the delegate in giving his or her report, encouraging not only the G.S.R.'s, but all A.A. members to attend.

Sharing between the area committee and G.S.R.'s promotes clearer understanding of our Traditions. Much is also accomplished at our annual Convention, where we hold structured workshops for the G.S.R.'s and committee members, A.A. speakers and an invited member of our G.S.O. staff.

Another innovation has been the invitation extended to guests, expenses paid, of at least three nonalcoholic professionals who are interested in, or involved with alcoholics, but who do not have any clear understanding how A.A. functions as a whole. They are selected from different parts of the area.

—Lenore M., E. Penna.

## BETTER RESPONSE FROM DELEGATES

It seems to me there's a very simple way to achieve this. A stronger effort, a little more acceptance of the responsibility we have already undertaken—this should never be considered a chore, but both a privilege and a pleasure.

For example, in the Sept. 1971 *Quarterly Report from G.S.O.*, the results of the A.A. survey approved by the 1971 Conference, showed that only 74 out of 90 Conference areas had returned their data by the deadline requested. In the business world, an 80% return such as this would bring on bonuses and banquets, but in A.A. we look for total response. Perfectionists? Maybe, but I think it's more dedication and an expression of gratitude.

There is a quotation (here excerpted) from the old "Third Legacy Manual and Twelve Concepts" that deals with the subject:

*"Mail Polls need close attention. At times each year the trustees will wish to conduct mail polls. . . to get a cross section of group opinion on vital decisions that have to be made. . . the delegates will need to enlist the cooperation of their committee members and G.S.R.'s. . . carefully done jobs will result in sure guidance for headquarters (G.S.O.) and serious blunders can be avoided. . . up to the present time our experience with polls has not been of the best. Too many delegates and committee members have neglected to make the effort. . . headquarters tries hard to avoid unnecessary polls. . . it is hoped for a much better response to the few that are vitally needed."*

I can think of something we all might do—that is, share our knowledge and experience with the newly elected delegate. It

## G.S.R. REPRESENTS YOUR GROUP



To represent it within the service structure of the Fellowship, your group elects a general service representative (G.S.R.).

## AREA COMMITTEES AND MEETINGS



Committee meetings, and meetings for G.S.R.'s are held monthly or quarterly to discuss service needs, and to report on world services.

is simply a transfer of these same responsibilities we have been carrying for the past two years. The end of our term doesn't mean we have earned the right to retire. As a source of information, we should always be willing to share, or a wealth of experience is lost. A well-informed delegate is the only effective one.

—Stu N., E. Mass.

## PAST DELEGATES

I don't feel that past delegates should be G.S.R.'s, committee members or chairmen of the area committees. There can be a tendency to feel they have all the answers, that everything should be done the way they want it done, otherwise it is wrong. Tactics and methods that were used years ago may be obsolete and ineffective now. . . they might destroy the very thing that is being sought—unity.

What can past delegates do? They can serve on special committees such as: institutions; conventions, conferences, assemblies and symposiums; public information; central offices and intergroups; workshops and sharing sessions, and district meetings of G.S.R.'s.

There isn't anything that bars them from these activities now. Certainly they are familiar enough with all aspects of A.A. to recognize where they can be helpful. . . those who wish to stay active will do so.

I don't feel that past delegates should be treated any differently than any other A.A. member; why place them in a special class? I have found that if you want something done, you pick those who are willing, whether they be old or new. Actually I can see no reason why past delegates would need to be polled on any subject. Most likely you would get opinions of what it used to be like instead of what it's like now.

I think consideration should be given to changing the A.A. Service Manual to reflect that past delegates should not serve

again as G.S.R.'s or committee members. And I suggest to the Agenda/Admissions Committee that this whole subject be discussed at the 1973 Conference.

—Carl B., So. Calif.

## Sense of the Meeting

A show of hands indicated that a majority (but less than two-thirds) of the Conference delegates felt that past delegates should continue to be active at the level of the area committees.

## LOCAL MISUNDERSTANDINGS—WITHIN A.A.

I would guess that most of us have experienced what G.S.O. very diplomatically refers to as "local misunderstandings." In my area, we call them rhubarbs, during which some of our colleagues mistakenly allow personalities to be placed over principles! The last such occurrence was caused by a dispute over whether a distinguished public figure should be asked to participate in the Bill Wilson Memorial Services last February 14. Certain committee members contacted G.S.O. asking for a ruling. G.S.O. rightfully refused to become involved. A special area committee meeting was held, and a majority voted to invite this well-known figure. Principles were put back over personalities; the group conscience prevailed and serenity was restored.

Local problems have been brought to the attention of G.S.O., in which this office is asked to act as mediator or judge. Often there is an implication that the alleged transgressors should be reprimanded, if not punished. The questions that arise are basic:

1. Should G.S.O. become involved in local misunderstandings, other than to share experience?
2. Should G.S.O. take any punitive action regarding any individual member of any group of A.A.'s?

In my opinion, the function of the General Service Office is to implement the policies approved by the General Service Conference to the best of its ability, to provide services to all who need or request them, and to share experience—not to judge or mediate in local disagreements. If G.S.O. were to do so, it would be absolutely besieged with disagreements between areas, groups and individuals and soon only the "winners" would accept G.S.O.'s authority; the losers might well question who gave G.S.O. the right to act as judge and jury.

I think the concept of the group conscience, the mechanism provided by the Third Legacy procedures, the Conference structure, provide a means through which local and area problems can be resolved. Therefore, I would again like to ask that this Conference reaffirm the 1963 Conference action: "that G.S.O. continue to refer local matters back to the area involved."

—Hal M., D.C.

## Conference Action

The Conference approved a resolution that G.S.O. should not be asked to intervene or involve itself in local disputes or misunderstandings.

# The Voice of the Conference Was Heard...



During scheduled workshop and Ask-it-Basket Conference sessions, the delegates had an opportunity to ask questions of the staff and of each other.

The G.S.O. staff members and trustees received

helpful guidance on a number of current problems and procedures through the following discussions and resulting actions:

## CLUBS

This presentation was based on findings of a questionnaire which went out to all clubs that are listed at G.S.O. Last year's Conference questioned whether G.S.O. could accept monies from clubs since many of us in A.A. say there is no such thing as an A.A. club and that clubs are operated independently of A.A. However, since they do exist and usually are composed largely or entirely of A.A. members, it has been suggested that they should abide by A.A. Tradition because they are apt to be known as an A.A. facility in the community.

Jack M., East Central regional trustee, shared some of the results of the questionnaire with the delegates, explaining that conclusions were based on 143 returns. Of these 143, 122 were defined as clubs because they indicated they charged dues, some owned a building, some rented out space, others required 30 days sobriety for membership, were chartered by the state or had formed corporations. The other 21 responses appeared to be groups rather than clubs.

The 122 clubs are described as follows:

**Dues:** 85 charge membership dues and 74 accept voluntary contributions from A.A. members, 53 are supported by dues, contributions, rent, literature and food service.

**Membership:** 95 consist of A.A. members only and 54 include Al-Anon or other nonalcoholics.

**Contributions:** 65 contribute to G.S.O. Of these 65, the 54 who include nonalcoholics as members would perhaps be in violation of the Tradition of self-support by accepting contributions outside the Fellowship.

**Meetings:** 117 allow A.A.'s who are not club members to attend A.A. meetings held at the club; 115 hold regular meetings at the club; 38 allow gambling (37 for money).

**Directors:** 105 are elected by the general membership.

**Rent:** 74 pay rent for the club, 46 rent out clubrooms for A.A. groups (6 rent rooms for non-A.A. activities); 42 own their own club.

**A.A. activities at the club:** 43 serve as A.A. service centers or intergroups for the area, and 114 responded they accepted Twelfth Step calls at the club.

Some of the clubs were started with a grant, but have been self-supporting since the grant, or the down payment was made by an individual and has been paid back.

Jack recommended that each delegate make sure that his committee members and G.S.R.'s have a copy of the A.A. guidelines on Clubs.

George G., Pacific region trustee, also spoke on the subject of clubs and whether or not G.S.O. should accept contributions from them. He said it was understandable that clubs, which consist generally of A.A. members, want to show their gratitude by contributing to world services, yet these contributions often are monies obtained from non-A.A. activities, such as gambling, raffles, rummage sales, lottery tickets, restaurant profits, etc. Many clubs who send contributions to G.S.O., George said, act as agents in forwarding group contributions.

"A club that collects \$3.00 per member of the group and forwards the amount to G.S.O. under the club name is not crediting the true source," he said. "There are also meetings held at clubs and the collections from these meetings are turned over to the clubs. This money could be intermingled with dues or other revenue. The club may again send these contributions in the name of the club. Under the meeting system, in relations to clubs, there is no representation at the local, state or world service levels. They have no voice in the decision or in the group conscience.

"Considering these facts," George continued, "it would seem to be a simple solution just to register each group without a club affiliation; contributions could be mailed directly to G.S.O. So the question is, should G.S.O. accept contributions from any club?"

• After discussion, the Conference agreed that G.S.O. should not accept contributions from clubs, listed or known as such, whether or not composed solely of A.A. members. Contributions are welcome from groups meeting in clubs as long as they are sent in in the name of the group.

A letter will be sent to delegates explaining this decision so they can inform clubs in their areas.

## 'FAMILY' GROUPS

Because of a significant increase in the number of "family" groups requesting listing in the *World Directory*, Valerie S. said the A.A. staff discussed the problem last fall with Al-Anon, who felt that the word "family," long identified with their fellowship, should not be used in the name of A.A. groups.

The 1971 Directory listed 33 such "family" groups. A questionnaire was sent to these groups, asking if officers and actual members were A.A.'s and if they would delete the word "family" from the group name. Ten groups responded; five were willing to drop the word "family." Three of these five



## GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

The North American Conference is the link between A.A. groups and G.S.O. There are 129 Conference members—area delegates, trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs—who meet annually and are active in Conference matters throughout the year. It provides a forum for sharing A.A. experience and reveals the group conscience.

stated their officers and members were A.A. members. So it isn't known whether the 28 groups not responding consist of A.A. members or not, with A.A. officers.

There is also an increase in the number of "special" groups. Regarding their listing in the Directory, G.S.O. feels these are not A.A. groups in keeping with our primary purpose or, in some cases, meeting membership requirements. G.S.O. has suggested that these groups be considered meetings in which A.A. members participate, and not A.A. groups.

Delegates were asked if "family" groups should be listed in the Directory—the majority said "no." Asked about an increase of such groups in which A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s participate, the majority said no increase, but about seven said there was an increase in their areas.

• After discussion, the Conference reaffirmed A.A. group policy that "only those with a desire to stop drinking may be members of A.A. groups; only A.A. members are eligible to be officers of A.A. groups; nonalcoholics are welcome at open meetings of A.A." It is suggested that the word "family" not be used in the name of an A.A. group; if A.A.'s and their non-alcoholic mates wish to meet together on a regular basis, it is suggested they consider these gatherings 'meetings' and not A.A. groups. *Listing in World Directory*: It was the sense of the meeting that the family groups should not be listed under the family group name in the Directory.

## NAMING AN A.A. GROUP AFTER AN INDIVIDUAL

Preceding floor discussion, Midge M. shared with the delegates something of the background of this practice. Responding to a question in a 1964 issue of *Box 4-5-9* as to whether this ought

to be done or not, the majority said "no" and many, in fact, called attention to Traditions 11 and 12. Each group being autonomous, this subject has had little discussion, but since Bill died, many groups are now naming themselves after him or other persons, living or deceased, or propose doing so.

Dr. Jack was asked for his opinion, and he requested this be discussed by the Board, who, in turn, referred the question to this Conference for guidance.

Midge explained it is G.S.O. policy when answering a group seeking our opinion to suggest that it select another name on the basis of "principles above personalities."

• After discussion, the Conference voiced the unanimous opinion that an A.A. group should not be named after an A.A. member or nonalcoholic, living or deceased.

## TAPE-MAKING

The desirability of making available tapes of all kinds of A.A. meetings including conferences, conventions, assemblies, etc. was explored on the Conference floor. Delegates listened to arguments for and against this practice. In favor: tapes would be of value to Loners and travelers; to those in hospitals and recovering convalescents; to isolated groups; to members, because of working hours unable to attend regular meetings. Against: they could be edited in such a way that a speaker could be blackmailed; might be used by people in outside agencies; some might sell tapes at a profit, making use of names of prominent people; indiscriminate use of tapes could cause anonymity breaks; authorizing only a specific person to tape and reproduce for sale may be felt to be unfair.

• After discussion, the Conference agreed that tape-making at all types of A.A. meetings with the possible exception of closed meetings, is helpful to some A.A.'s and that the decision of making tapes be left to group autonomy.

## NARCOTICS, DRUGS and A.A.

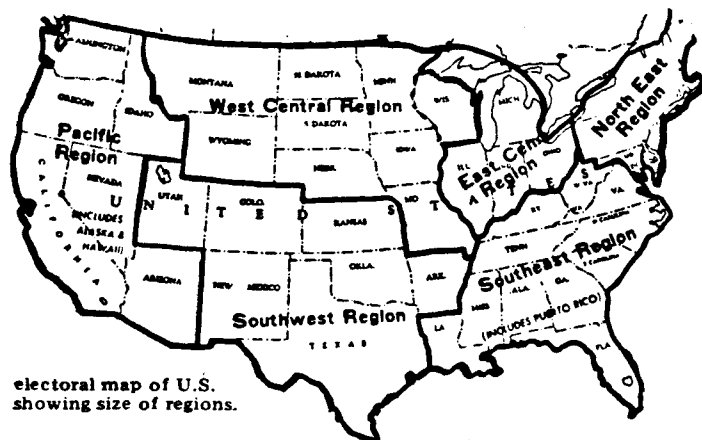
A longtime and continuing problem for many A.A. groups is that of the drug user attending A.A. meetings, participating in them and in some cases, holding office. A show of hands indicated that more than one half the delegates are concerned with this problem in their areas.

A letter from an A.A. member to G.S.O. was read, outlining in some detail the problem in his area and how the members felt about it. It had been suggested to him in an earlier letter that Bill's pamphlet, "Problems Other Than Alcohol" might be helpful and he agreed that it would; in fact, he had asked members of the area committee to have their groups obtain copies from G.S.O. and keep a supply on hand.

• After discussion, it was moved that G.S.O. prepare a clear-cut statement of what A.A. is and what it is not, and unanimously agreed that "alcohol and pill" groups not be listed in A.A. directories and meeting lists.

(cont'd. on p. 14)

## CHANGE OF REGION FOR WISCONSIN



Joe B., Panel 21, So. Wisconsin, and regional trustees Jack M. (East Central) and Don F. (West Central) gave presentations, advocating a change of region for the state of Wisconsin from its present position in the West Central region to the East Central region.

Joe B. provided some background, saying that these areas of Southern Wisconsin and Northern Wisconsin-Upper Michigan have been working toward this change, as the matter of regional size was becoming important; it is difficult to cover the nine states comprising the West Central region. He said "it was also determined that when the Northern Wisconsin and Upper Peninsula of Michigan elected a delegate, all of Upper Michigan voted with that area." But that in the matter of voting for trustees, "When the East Central region elects a trustee, Upper Michigan is invited to vote with that region. But when the West Central region votes for a trustee, the Upper Michigan area voted along. So two votes were cast, whereby one vote was all in accordance with the usual procedure. . . believing that a change-over was most necessary, we decided to bring up this matter at our regional Conference, where at a meeting of past and present delegates this idea was approved."

Jack M. also provided information about the original Third Legacy provision for Michigan's delegate selections. In summation he said, "Because of the extent of Don's area, and the great distance required for him to travel to the northern portion of Wisconsin and Upper Michigan, and because of the fact that one delegate serves both the Upper Peninsula of Michigan and Northern Wisconsin, there is no question in my mind that Wisconsin should be in the East Central region with its neighboring states of Michigan and Illinois."

Don F. also voiced full agreement with the views of Joe and Jack.

• The Conference unanimously approved the proposal to change Wisconsin from the West Central to the East Central region.

## 'STEPPING STONES'

Bill and Lois agreed they would like their home to go jointly to A.A. and Al-Anon for use as a memorial library and provisions were made to insure this in both their wills. In discussing this at Policy and Board meetings and in correspondence with several delegates, several points were brought up:

1. That this would be against Traditions, either accepting a large sum from a non-A.A. (Lois), or more than \$200 (raised to \$300 by 1972 Conference) from an A.A. (Bill).
2. That it would lead to problems of joint ownership with Al-Anon.
3. That it would be setting a precedent.
4. That it would result in a financial drain and possible legal complications.
5. Bill needs no memorial; A.A. is his living memorial.

The Board voted to recommend to the Conference that in accordance with A.A.'s Tradition of self-support, A.A. not accept "Stepping Stones" for any purpose.

• The Conference voted unanimously not to accept this property.

## BILL'S MEMORIAL FUND

There have been a number of suggestions from delegates, trustees and others regarding the disposition of the \$3,600 donated by members to Bill's Memorial Fund. Among these are:

1. Production of a public information film on A.A. to be shown to the public.
2. Deposit the money in the General Fund.
3. Purchase of literature for prisons.
4. Establish a living memorial, such as a scholarship for a medical student to study alcoholism.
5. Purchase literature for school libraries.

• After discussion, the Conference agreed to defer decision on the use of this fund so that delegates may discuss with their groups the suggestion of a film about A.A., historical or for public information purposes, and come back next year prepared to make a decision on this, or some other suggestions.

## UNSTRUCTURED WORKSHOP

There were nine workshops, in which some 56 questions were asked and answers given. Categories (including a "miscellaneous" one) were: Drugs, Clubs, Conference, Miami Convention, Groups, General Service Activities, Agencies, the General Service Board and Literature.

Because of the amount of material that emerged from these workshops, it's not possible to condense it adequately for inclusion in this Report. Therefore it is suggested that anyone wishing a copy of the full reporting, as done by the reporters and compiled by the "report-back" reporter, may write to G.S.O.



# Personal Service Highlights

**ALASKA**—My entrance into service work began about three months after my last drink. I have served as secretary of my home group and two years as G.S.R. of the Totem Group when we moved to Alaska. Later, I became manager of our Alano Club and board trustee. After serving as alternate delegate, I was drawn from the hat for delegate. I have learned responsibility, to handle criticism and to rely on a power greater than myself.

—Guy K.

**ALBERTA**—Sober a few days, my sponsor took me to a jail group. Institutional work became my “thing” for the next nine years. Always looking for more than life had to offer, I didn’t find it until I saw and felt the “group conscience” work in assembly meetings. Service work is picking up in our province.

—Jim H.

**ARIZONA**—After six weeks in A.A. I was elected alternate G.S.R.; later I served as group secretary and intergroup representative. I have been blessed for more than life had to offer, I didn’t find it until I saw and felt the “group conscience” work in assembly meetings. Service work is picking up in our province.

—Red D.

**CALIFORNIA (Mid-Southern)**—To accomplish our goal of enlightening our people to the responsibilities of those involved in G.S. work, we place articles in our area bulletins, hold local assemblies, monthly breakfasts, area panel meetings and use past delegates as coordinators in their respective areas. We hope this will encourage involvement by more people.

—John McA.

**CALIFORNIA (No. Interior)**—Our former delegate, Cliff J., explained General Service work to me, but I was busy then, trying to stay sober. Later I became interested in institutional work and I’m still active in this area. My service participation began as a G.S.R. and I haven’t been able to say “no” to any job I am asked to do. It is my life, as it is the very lifeline of A.A.

—Bob B.

**CALIFORNIA (San Diego)**—When the Third Legacy Plan was confirmed at the St. Louis Convention and responsibility turned over to the membership, our group had only a hazy idea how this applied to individual members. Later, at an area assembly meeting in Los Angeles, I listened and learned as Cliff W. and Chuck C. explained our new responsibilities, the structure of our society and the part the 12 Traditions should play in our daily lives.

—Chuck B.

**DELAWARE**—I knew very little about service, prior to my nomination as G.S.R., or about the workings of G.S.O., or how the Delaware area assembly functioned, or the Third Legacy. Only through becoming involved did I learn and realize how vital these things are. If A.A. is to survive, and maintain its leadership, the lines of communication must be kept open at all levels, and we must continue to serve all.

—Carl K.

**GEORGIA**—Early in A.A. it was evident to me that the people in my group who were sober and happy were those who took an active part in group functions, and I attached myself to these people. I was elected secretary-treasurer and

attended my first state assembly meeting. The many areas of service that were opened gave me a completely new concept of working the A.A. program and the rewards put into service work are very great.

—John D.

**IDAHO**—I became interested in General Service through a growing awareness of the full meaning of our 12th Step and participation as a G.S.R. in group and area affairs. I have listened with great interest to Conference reports of Idaho’s past delegates and it is my prayer today that from this experience the scope of my personal service will be broadened.

—Ted B.

**ILLINOIS (Northern)**—Over a period of time I grew aware of the distinction between local service and General Service. Concepts like “group conscience” and “together we share what no one of us can possess alone” intrigued me. I felt that much of my training could be utilized in General Service work; my first experience was as a district committee member. My present assignment is a challenge to try to contribute to a more effective structure in Northern Illinois along the lines of the Third Legacy.

—Louis D., Jr.

**INDIANA (Southern)**—I became interested in General Service work by listening to what was said and asking how I could help. I’ve served as my group’s G.S.R., as our area committee member, chairman of our state convention, alternate delegate and now as delegate. I attend a lot of conventions and try to continue to listen and learn.

—Don O.

**KANSAS**—Though I have served as secretary, treasurer and G.S.R. for my groups, I didn’t really know what service meant until I was elected district committee member; then I wanted to know more. State assembly meetings take place each quarter. Better communication has been brought about by the larger number of districts and individual participation.

—Ben P.

**KENTUCKY**—I have served as secretary and treasurer of the Erlanger Group for 7 years and also G.S.R.; four years ago, as district committee member, I started attending state area committee meetings and found there is a beautiful horizon above the group level; I try to pass the thought on to my G.S.R.’s.

—Criss R.

**MAINE**—From the start, I always attended state meetings and had an interest in serving. I had been G.S.R. at different times and wanted to accept a state office but was afraid of making mistakes until my wife became an Al-Anon delegate, and I saw how rewarding service can be. This past fall I was elected alternate delegate, but Ernie, our delegate, became sick . . . and here I am, hoping to listen and learn and pass on my experience.

—Roland R.

**MANITOBA**—My entry into service work occurred suddenly when my group concluded they needed a G.S.R. and Tom G., pointing at me, said “What about him?” Later, as part of a visiting panel, we discussed literature, finance, sponsorship, etc. and as more understanding came, a new way of life and thinking opened up. The thought and kindness learned from other people have kept me in service work ever since.

—Bill H.

## SERVICE HIGHLIGHTS

**MARYLAND**—As a result of the new unity among the A.A. groups in Maryland, we held our first state A.A. convention last July. It was a privilege for me to serve on that first convention committee and to tell you it was a success beyond expectations. My own experience in General Service has been most rewarding and helped me to grow in A.A. I am grateful for the opportunity to serve our Fellowship. —*Bill C.*

**MASSACHUSETTS (Western)**—My sponsor was a “doer” rather than a talker, active in service work. He saw that I spoke at many kinds of institutions when he felt I was ready. Sometime later, attending a General Service meeting, I began to realize the scope of A.A. Now, our active Institutions Committee meets monthly, as does Intergroup, and our area committee meets bi-monthly. So we’re growing in service and will continue. —*Dick D.*

**MICHIGAN (Western)**—I was introduced to General Service work by Ed L., our past delegate. He took me to meetings of the service committee. I enjoyed this and soon after asked a group if I could be its G.S.R.! That was the start of a rewarding life of A.A. service. —*Archie M.*

**MINNESOTA (Northern)**—Serving as my group’s secretary-treasurer, as G.S.R., committee member and participating actively in assembly meetings made me realize the vast amount of work that is done at G.S.O. and the whole area of General Service, and the importance of each group doing its share. Serving as delegate is the highlight of my whole life up to now. —*Frank J.*

**MISSISSIPPI**—Have served as G.S.R., assistant G.S.R. and state convention chairman since coming into A.A. in 1965. I have tried to attend every state quarterly and convention meeting since that time. I feel that being elected delegate is a privilege and great responsibility, and I will try to serve to the best of my ability. —*Henry W.*

**MONTANA**—I served three years as G.S.R. for my group and still support and help keep the group active. Our membership varies from 3 to 12 members. I have attended A.A. conferences and meetings throughout the state; perhaps this is why I was chosen as an area committee member during the tenure of our last delegate. I hope I can contribute just a little to the Fellowship as a whole. —*Bob S.*

**NEBRASKA**—When a young man asked me for help to “get what I had,” I realized it was the power of attraction that succeeded, not promotion which I, as an A.A. super salesman, had been attempting. As G.S.R. and a committee member, I also became aware of the close relationship between Recovery and Service; our job is to insure that this service will always be available. —*Doug M.*

**N.B./P.E.I.**—In 1957, at our N.S. conference, the idea of G.S.R.’s, committee members, delegates, etc., was accepted and put into action. I soon found out it was the group member’s responsibility to carry the message to those still suffering. I became involved in starting groups in jails, county hospitals and Indian Reservations. I always try to attend conferences as they give me a further insight into our Fellowship. —*Bob G.*

**NEW HAMPSHIRE**—I attended our state assembly for about a year. When we started a new meeting in Manchester, I became G.S.R., secretary, treasurer, coffee maker, cleaner-upper and

hat-check clerk! I was elected secretary-treasurer of the N.H. state assembly for 1969-70 and in 1971 elected delegate. The delegate at the end of his term automatically becomes chairman of the state assembly for two years. —*Gordon B.*

**NEW JERSEY (Southern)**—Because our group is a small one, there is lots of activity for each member in group and area service. After serving as delegate to our Intergroup and later as Intergroup chairman, my group appointed me G.S.R. When So. N.J. undertook its annual convention, I “volunteered” for the committee and enjoy it. I served as alternate delegate and chairman of our area assembly before being elected as Conference delegate. —*Tom W.*

**NEW MEXICO**—After serving as G.S.R. for my group, I became the area committee member from my district which led to deeper involvement in General Service work. My two years’ service as chairman of our area committee also was valuable experience. I feel the legacy of service is a trust; we are servants, not manipulators. To me, service is the key to individual growth in A.A. —*Jim O’N.*

**NEW YORK (H/M/B)**—During my first two years in A.A., I was active in my group and able to attend area conferences and state conventions. So I was grateful when my group asked me to be its G.S.R. After another two years, I was elected secretary of the area committee, then continued to serve as its treasurer, chairman and now delegate. I’m sure these will be rewarding years. —*Mary T.*

**NEW YORK (Western)**—Serving as chairman of our newly reorganized P.I.C. some three years ago has proved to be a worthwhile challenge. This committee is made up of district committee members, numbering 12 persons. We prepare an annual report which reflects the steady growth of P.I.C. in our area and the effects of better group and outside communication. A copy of the report goes to G.S.O. —*Ralph Z.*

**NORTH DAKOTA**—Representing my group at area and state conferences started me wondering how I could better serve A.A. Though benefiting greatly from attending the University of No. Dakota’s Summer School of Alcohol Studies for 3 summers, it was at Miami that I became intensely interested in General Service work, and began studying all phases of A.A. services. In the A.A. Service Manual and the Twelve Concepts especially, I realized the answers were available all the time. —*Dennett H.*

**OHIO (N.W.)/MICHIGAN (S.E.)**—I served first as alternate G.S.R. to my group, then after several years, as G.S.R. I also served four years as treasurer of our assembly, two years as chairman and was elected delegate this past year. It is gratifying to see better communication in our area between the public and A.A. —*Jim W.*

**OHIO (S.W.)/KENTUCKY (North)**—After attending my first state conference, I realized I had to get involved, so I was asked to serve as my group’s secretary and began to understand that action and service are the keys, for me, to staying sober. As G.S.R., I attended area meetings and learned the importance of communication between G.S.R., the area and the individual group. I later served as area treasurer, secretary and chairman. We use the Service Manual in our area elections, hold area meetings regularly and so keep the area well informed. —*Ken W.*



**ONTARIO (Western)**—My sponsor said, "Get active," so I started as group secretary, then served as intergroup representative and on our steering committee, all of which I enjoyed. After being alternate G.S.R., I served as committee member for our district and saw that service is really the heart of our program, that all dedicated members ought to be willing to give of themselves when asked.  
—*Dunc M.*

**OREGON**—I became enthusiastic about General Service work after reading "A.A. Comes of Age" and "The Third Legacy Manual." I think members who don't wish to serve or share are missing out on personal growth, a sense of accomplishment and the serenity these bring. We are trying to have more sharing sessions, G.S.R. meetings, and are inviting members (as spectators) to attend our quarterly committee meetings.  
—*Chet C.*

**PUERTO RICO**—I developed a spirit of service by reading articles and books about A.A. After attending the Miami Convention and the Guatemala Convention in 1971, I started visiting prisons and jails, leaving A.A. literature with them. My first elected service was group secretary. I believe in service work; it gives me life and sobriety.  
—*Zandos R.*

**QUEBEC (Southwest, English)**—Early in A.A. oldtimers told me "You don't say 'no'. . . if you're grateful, pay." So I did what I was told. Later, in Ottawa, I learned about General Service work from Alf Mc., a delegate from E. Ont. Back in the Montreal area and into service work in earnest, I asked my group for the G.S.R. job! I'll do my best as delegate — it's my way of saying thanks.  
—*Sheila M.*

**QUEBEC (Southwest, French-speaking)**—It is now my third year in Quebec General Service and with the good work of our committee, groups have increased their number during the past three years from 300 to 478 and membership has increased accordingly. I am glad to report the good understanding and enthusiasm amongst French- and English-speaking groups and members.  
—*Elmer S.*

**RHODE ISLAND**—My interest in General Service began when I was secretary of our group. Our G.S.R. wasn't able to attend assembly meetings, so I volunteered to attend. At my very first meeting I was tremendously impressed by the devotion and unselfishness of other G.S.R.'s and I was anxious to follow along with them. Every minute of service has been gratifying.  
—*Swan J.*

**SASKATCHEWAN**—We hold several assemblies annually, the workshop on General Service, and Provincial Conference. We also have an active Alcoholism Commission. Communications are a problem; we move our provincial meetings geographically each year, because distance is a factor making it difficult for G.S.R.'s to meet, though 50% do attend meetings. Our members help prison groups and groups on the Reservations.  
—*George D.*

**SOUTH CAROLINA**—I became interested in General Service work by watching G.S.R.'s, committee members and delegates in action; they worked hard and seemed happy and dedicated. Later, I served my state as secretary. Our recent service activities: obtaining a Big Book in Braille for a blind member of our group and putting on a "get-together" of past and present area delegates.  
—*Lloyd G.*

**SOUTH DAKOTA**—I think two words, gratitude and responsibility, explain the reason for my interest in General Service work. I'm grateful for A.A. reaching out and lifting me up; in accepting responsibility for serving, I'm accomplishing another step in growing up. I've been secretary and G.S.R. of my group and had other jobs. The opportunity to work with the General Service Board has shown me the next step in this wonderful world of A.A.  
—*Marvin B.*

**TENNESSEE**—After three years of continuous sobriety, I was elected G.S.R. to the state assembly, and I became much interested in General Service work. After six years of sobriety, I have a great desire to dedicate myself to this great Fellowship which saved my life. I have traveled a great deal, visiting other groups in the state and surrounding states.  
—*Earl L.*

**TEXAS (Northwest)**—Early in sobriety I enjoyed conferences and meetings away from home. My group elected me G.S.R. and I became involved immediately. Later, I was asked to be a district committee member and participated in the structuring of our area committee. I recognize the need for being a *part* of the total Fellowship rather than *apart* from it. Service is a privilege.  
—*LaVelle C.*

**TEXAS (Southwest)**—Only 30 days in A.A. when Kate R. gave her Conference report to our group, I knew nothing of G.S.O.; when she ended, I knew something about A.A. worldwide. I became active, and my association with our area delegates made me want to do more General Service work. I have served as G.S.R., committee member and chairman of our Intergroup Committee, and now as delegate—though I still wash my group's coffee cups!  
—*Elves S.*

**VERMONT**—My work as G.S.R. was most rewarding to me and to our group's alternate G.S.R. Because of our close affiliation in A.A. we were able to keep our group well informed of the work of the state assembly. It has been a great honor and most rewarding to have been named my state's delegate.  
—*Howard S.*

**WISCONSIN (No. Wisc./Upper Mich.)**—Only four months in A.A., I asked to be G.S.R. and group treasurer; it added a new dimension to my A.A. life. Later, as a Loner, I joined World Hello and G.S.O.'s Loners Meeting. In my area, we have long had Intergroup and G.S.R. meetings. Now we have a service committee that cooperates with G.S.R.'s in the 3 districts. We publish an A.A. directory, cooperate with the state alcoholism information and referral program and the local alcoholism therapy unit.  
—*Wilbert L.*

**WYOMING**—My wife and I enjoy visiting other groups throughout the state and neighboring states; we try to attend all conferences that we can. While we were in Casper last September for the state Fall Conference, I was approached to accept the nomination for delegate and I replied that I had too many obligations to accept. But my friends asked "Where is your first obligation" and here I am, my first endeavor in General Service work.  
—*Stan M.*

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The average sobriety age of the 1972 delegates was 11½ years.

# G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs

## A.A.W.S. REPORT

(Bob H., chairman)

A.A.W.S., Inc., is a membership corporation, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. As members of the corporation, the trustees elect the 7 directors of A.A.W.S., Inc. at their annual meeting in April. Currently there are 59 employees which include 13 on a part-time basis.

Last year a committee on Office Policy and Procedure was established, composed of the general manager, the service coordinator, the staff coordinator, the controller and the office manager. It deals only with office matters.

There was a substantial increase in A.A. literature distribution last year: sales came to \$678,500, an increase of \$148,900 over 1970. A.A.W.S. contributed \$100,000 to the General Fund to help defray costs of other services. Dis-

tribution of all material in 1971 totaled 3,080,900 individual units. Distribution of free literature amounted to 274,200 pieces, to service new groups and to inform the general public.

**Accounting:** 19,380 orders were processed last year, as well as 20,930 contributions. Charles Columbia, also assistant controller, heads up this department. There are 7 full-time employees and one part-time. This department also maintains the general books, prepares payrolls, financial reports, budget controls and comparisons.

**Records:** Supervised by Barbara Netterwald, assisted by Kamla Cheddie, there are 8 girls, including one part-timer. They are responsible for compiling the *World Directory* and the Institutions directories, maintain files for new groups, Loners, Internationalists, delegates and G.S. committee members and G.S.O. mailing lists.

**Shipping:** Supervised by Al Cryan and Heywood Hicks as assistant manager, this department employs 7 full-time and 13 part-time employees. Last year, 87,474 incoming letters were handled and 77,808 sent out. Book and pamphlet orders accounted for 77,095 packages shipped to all parts of the world.

**Steno/Clerical:** Supervised by Ann Couig, assisted by Denise Stern, there are 7 full-time transcribers and two part-time. Two clerk typists handle form letters, with help from the receptionist and switchboard operator. The file research analyst, a file clerk and assistant archivist and the general manager's secretary complete this department.

## SERVICE COORDINATOR

(Ann M.)

The service coordinator acts as liaison between department heads, staff and,

## LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED - 1971

### BOOKS

|                                                         |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Alcoholics Anonymous .....                              | 69,104         |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition) ..... | 27,065         |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition) ..... | 8,989          |
| Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age .....                 | 8,395          |
| As Bill Sees It .....                                   | 13,737         |
| Alcoholics Anonymous - Spanish Edition .....            | 1,221          |
| <b>Total</b> .....                                      | <b>128,511</b> |

### PAMPHLETS

|                                               |         |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------|
| This is A.A. ....                             | 226,252 |
| A.A. - 44 Questions and Answers .....         | 192,029 |
| Is A.A. For You? .....                        | 290,098 |
| Young People and A.A. ....                    | 119,692 |
| A.A. For the Woman .....                      | 96,479  |
| Alcoholism the Illness .....                  | 122,369 |
| The Alcoholic Husband .....                   | 108,953 |
| The Alcoholic Wife .....                      | 79,406  |
| Memo to an Inmate .....                       | 50,335  |
| Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic ..... | 113,250 |
| The Jack Alexander Article - About A.A. ....  | 68,748  |
| The Fortune Story About A.A. ....             | 48,192  |
| Letter to a Woman Alcoholic .....             | 78,184  |
| Questions and Answers on Sponsorship .....    | 67,125  |
| What Happened to Joe .....                    | 95,660  |
| It Happened to Alice .....                    | 83,342  |
| The A.A. Group .....                          | 46,483  |
| A.A. Tradition - How It Developed .....       | 39,724  |
| Inside A.A. ....                              | 36,543  |

|                                                         |                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| The G.S.R. ....                                         | 40,278           |
| A Member's Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous (New) ..... | 141,572          |
| A.A. and the Medical Profession .....                   | 52,332           |
| A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee .....                   | 43,276           |
| A Clergyman Asks About A.A. ....                        | 43,864           |
| A.A. in Prisons .....                                   | 23,324           |
| A.A. in Hospitals .....                                 | 26,074           |
| The Fellowship of A.A. ....                             | 85,235           |
| A.A. in Your Community .....                            | 154,579          |
| The A.A. Service Manual .....                           | 3,540            |
| Twelve Concepts For World Service .....                 | 2,901            |
| Student's Guide (New) .....                             | 84,811           |
| Why A.A. Is Anonymous (New) .....                       | 40,836           |
| Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends (New) .....          | 7,020            |
| Alcoholism Is A Management Problem .....                | 52,412           |
| Problems Other Than Alcohol (New ) .....                | 44,376           |
| Alcoholics Anonymous Survey .....                       | 23,854           |
| Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings .....                     | 10,910           |
| Foreign Translations .....                              | 98,916           |
| <b>Total</b> .....                                      | <b>2,942,974</b> |

### MISCELLANEOUS

|                                         |         |
|-----------------------------------------|---------|
| Tapes of A.A. Talks .....               | 437     |
| Wallet Cards - 2 Fold .....             | 435,561 |
| Wallet Cards - "I Am Responsible" ..... | 66,884  |
| Parchment Scrolls .....                 | 3,183   |
| Plaques .....                           | 741     |
| How It Works .....                      | 124,897 |
| Newcomer's Meeting Kit .....            | 1,404   |
| Group Handbook .....                    | 2,602   |
| Wire Racks .....                        | 1,724   |

# Report on Their Activities

general manager. To carry our A.A. message as effectively as possible, certain services are provided to help groups and members in particular areas of service responsibility.

**New Groups:** Each receives a complimentary supply of literature and Group Handbook and is put on the Box 4-5-9 mailing list. Last year, 1,806 groups were added from the U.S. and Canada. G.S.B.'s in other countries often service their own new groups; if not, G.S.O. does.

**New Directories:** *World Directory* Part I is issued to delegates and then mailed to all groups in the U.S. and Canada, no charge. Part II, available in August, is also mailed free of charge to all overseas groups. *Hospital and Prison Directories* are issued every two years.

**Guidelines:** There are now 13. Subjects include: Alcoholic Rehab Centers, Armed Services, Central Offices, Clubs, Conventions and Conferences, Courts, P.I. Committees, Relationship between A.A. and Al-Anon, Industry, Institutional Committees, A.A.'s employed in the Alcoholism Field, A.A. Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies, A.A. Participation During Alcoholism Information Month.

**Films:** During the past year, 175 requests for "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and "Time for Decision" were processed. A filmstrip on G.S.O. activities is now in the works.

**Service for the Sightless:** the Big Book and "12 and 12" are available on tape and in Braille.

**Box 4-5-9:** mailed bimonthly in English, French and Spanish, to a mailing list of 30,700. We are exploring ways to improve it and make it more available.

**Other Services:** *Tapes and Cassettes.* The tapes are being reviewed. Our first cassette tape, a talk of Bill's called "A.A.'s Legacy of Service," is now available. We are working on a Tape Correspondence Service.

## GROUPS and MEMBERS

Spring 1972

|                       | Groups        | Members        |
|-----------------------|---------------|----------------|
| United States . . .   | 10,342        | 181,419        |
| Canada . . . . .      | 1,815         | 29,073         |
| Overseas* . . . . .   | 3,921         | 71,349         |
| Lone Members . . .    |               | 478            |
| In Hospitals . . . .  | 783           | 16,900         |
| In Prisons . . . . .  | 915           | 30,300         |
| Internationalists . . |               | 388            |
| <b>Total</b>          | <b>17,776</b> | <b>329,907</b> |

\*1971 count, until Part II of the *World Directory* is published in August 1972.

(including non-reported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 575,000 worldwide.)

## STAFF COORDINATOR (Midge M.)

"What do you staff members do?" is the question most frequently asked by visitors to G.S.O. and by other members. G.S.O. is basically a correspondence office, an A.A. communications center for sharing of experience around the A.A. world. One staffer corresponds with each of the geographic regions in the U.S. and Canada. More than 1,000 letters a month go out to groups and members.

The staff coordinator watches the flow of mail and re-assigns correspondence of any staff member out sick, on vacation, or working on a special project. She also keeps records of office meetings, staff vacations and trip schedules. Last year the staff enjoyed their participation in 56 area and regional conferences and get-togethers.

The staff coordinator also serves as assistant secretary of the G.S.B., secretary of the Trustees' Policy Committee on Conference Policy. She is also a director of A.A.W.S., Inc. and represents the staff on the Office Policy and Procedure Committee and at Department Managers' meetings.

She works very closely with a new staff member during her period of training.

Staff members keep up to date on each other's activities via the daily circulating correspondence folders and by sharing reports on their assignments at bi-weekly staff meetings.

More than 980 visitors were welcomed at G.S.O. in 1971; friends from Africa, Australia, New Zealand, India, Japan, among others.

## CONFERENCE SECRETARY (Waneta N.)

Last year we talked with delegates about the importance of advising G.S.O. of their newly elected trusted servants, before the Dec. 1 deadline for the *World Directory*, Part I. Some elections were held earlier than usual and we're grateful to all the secretaries of the area committees for their help.

Communication has been excellent this past year. We have learned much from receiving copies of area meeting minutes; many area committees make use of workshops, sharing sessions, buzz sessions, challenge sessions, Box 4-5-9, G.S.O. filmstrip, the Grapevine, and Bill's films.

There are approximately 608 past delegates listed at G.S.O. who receive Box 4-5-9 and other information.

Last year Conference members asked that past delegates receive the *Quarterly Report* and they now do so. This report, covering activities of the G.S.O., Trustees Committees, A.A.W.S., Inc. and the Grapevine, Inc., is prepared by the Conference secretary for delegates, past delegates, and committee members.

The Conference secretary assumes responsibility for: preparation of the Conference agenda (with the general manager and Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee), works with Records Department to assure proper listing of G.S. area committees, corresponds with delegates, past and present, and area committees, reviews minutes of area meetings, serves as secretary to the Conference Agenda/Admissions Committee.

(cont'd on p. 20)

### INSTITUTIONS

(Phyllis M.)

We have almost 800 groups in hospitals now, and well over 900 groups in prisons. There are 100 Institutions Committees throughout the world, with the greatest number in the U.S. and Canada.

To help extend the hand of fellowship, the following services have been developed:

(1) **Correspondence:** Besides regular contact with G.S.O., a new Institutions Correspondence Service was started last year. About 150 inmates are receiving mail from about 35 members of this service from all over the world.

(2) **New Groups:** These are registered at G.S.O. and are sent a package of complimentary literature and a Group Handbook.

(3) **Institutions Directories:** Every two years these are updated.

(4) **World Directory** (Parts I or II): Each group receives annually the appropriate directory.

(5) **Bulletins:** Each group receives Box 4-5-9 bimonthly and a copy of the Institutions Bulletin three times a year.

(6) **Literature:** Available to Institutions groups at a considerable discount and a copy of the Big Book is provided free of charge.

(7) **Guidelines:** Three sets are of particular interest: Cooperation with Rehab Centers, Cooperation with Courts, and Institutions Committees.

(8) **Tapes and Films:** Available free of charge to interested groups.

(9) **Institutions Committees and Sponsors:** Their only purpose is to carry the message to the confined alcoholic.

### INTERNATIONALISTS

(Valerie S.)

There are now approximately 400 Internationalists listed at G.S.O.

Many A.A. groups in foreign ports today were started by Internationalists. One seaman started a ham radio group some years ago which carries the message worldwide via the air waves.

Our Internationalists' Service provides a way for seagoing A.A.'s to keep in touch with the program through correspondence with each other and G.S.O.

Besides a list of names and addresses of other A.A. seaman and the *World Directory*, they receive the *Round Robin* bimonthly and *Box 4-5-9* on alternate months.

Our list of Internationalists now carries only A.A.'s who spend time at sea. A few longtime A.A.'s, retired and living in port areas are listed at G.S.O. as "Port Contacts."

### LONERS

(Beth K.)

At the present time, G.S.O. lists approximately 500 Loners. Of these, 40 are Spanish and 16 are French. During the past year, a number of Loners started groups; one in Tel Aviv, Israel; another in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia and several in Viet Nam, among others. Also, a new Loner is in Czechoslovakia. We list about 200 Loner Sponsors; these attend group meetings but like to Twelfth Step through correspondence.

### OVERSEAS

(Beth K.)

A highlight in the overseas picture this year was Lois' around-the-world trip. She visited A.A. and Al-Anon groups in South Africa, Australia, New Zealand, Japan and Hawaii. (See p. 33)

A.A. growth in countries outside the U.S. and Canada continues: There is an intergroup in Tokyo, Japan, though A.A. fluctuates there. A group has been started in Tel Aviv, Israel, through efforts of two Loners. In Viet Nam there are 14 groups and 15 Loners. The first Southeast Asian A.A. conference was held in Saigon in December.

There is a group in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia grown from a Loner. Plans are being worked out for a G.S.B. and G.S.O. for Australia. In El Salvador the main problem is the printing of A.A. G.S.C.-approved literature by several printers in that country without permission.

Bristol, England, was host to the European Convention. The Armed Forces groups in Germany have formed an

intergroup. The Big Book has been translated in Icelandic.

The Irish G.S.B. serving all Irish groups requested that an Irish delegate attend the World Service Meeting in October. Sackville, M., an A.A. trustee of the Board and another A.A. member, Travers C., were invited to Rome and had an audience with Pope Paul, who welcomed them and commended the work of A.A.

Mexico has translated and printed most of our literature; their national directory lists 380 groups. A General Service Board has been started for French-speaking groups in Switzerland.

### PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

(Cora Louise B.)

At the 1971 Conference, we reported on our efforts to learn something about other agencies and individuals concerned with the problems of alcoholism, to let them know we wish to work with them, within our Traditions, in a friendly and cooperative way. As a result, we have been able to accept invitations for staff and trustee participation at many national and international events.

The Professional Exhibit was shown at 14 meetings of professional associations last year.

Seventy-five A.A. members, employed as professionals in the alcoholism field, were asked to share their experience with us, through a questionnaire. Approximately 45 replies were received and this data has been used in preparing Guidelines for "A.A. Members Who Wear Two Hats."

Other recent Guidelines include: "A.A. Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities," "A.A. Cooperation with Industrial Programs," and a revision of "A.A. Participation in Alcoholism Information Month."

Current delegates were sent area addresses of N.A.A.A.P. and N.C.A. affiliates and members, and the Alcoholism Rehabilitation Programs of the O.E.O., so they can establish friendly relationships with the local executive directors.

Excerpts from "Problems Other Than Alcohol" (by Bill, Grapevine 1958) were condensed into a one-page statement on A.A. policy regarding A.A. membership and nonalcoholic addicts. It was sent, with a cover letter, to treatment facilities in one Midwestern state. We can provide the same service for other areas, on request, or provide the statement and cover letter for distribution in the area, as needed.

As of February, we have received 40 requests for material and suggestions from high-ranking armed forces officers in the U.S., Viet Nam and Europe. We sent literature, "Guidelines for Armed Forces Groups," lists of armed forces groups active in the U.S., S.E. Asia and Europe.

## PUBLIC INFORMATION (Mary Ellen U.)

A.A. Public Information tries to keep the public informed about A.A. and we have been able to do this through 8,273 inquiries received during 1971. Another way of carrying the message is through the press, and last year we had 3,245 press clippings, of which 1,000 related to Bill's death.

During 1971, there were also 107 anonymity breaks; 173 radio and TV spots were distributed; 29 One-Way Displays were sent with P.I. labels and pamphlets for local use. Material and information was provided to some 21 newspaper and magazine writers, and to 4 radio and TV shows. A.A. is now listed in 33 encyclopedias and reference books.

The Annual Report to the Public was sent with the October P.I. Bulletin; the Anonymity letter to the press was mailed to 3,000 newspapers in September.

The 21st Conference voted to conduct a survey in the U.S. and Canada to get information about the size, composition and effectiveness of our Fellowship. Delegates were sent questionnaires to be distributed to G.S.R.'s and were returned the following month. The results will become available during the course of the present year.

## GRAPEVINE

(Jack M., Paula C., co-editors)

Grapevine circulation reached a new high of 64,000 this year. The Grapevine 1972 calendar sold out and other Grapevine items moved well. Due to the healthy growth of the magazine, we will be able to hold the per-copy cost to 35 cents for the foreseeable future. A contribution of \$12,000 to the General Fund was voted by the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Equally gratifying was a sense of the growing interest in the Grapevine from the Fellowship. Our mail has been voluminous and enthusiastic. The number and quality of manuscripts sent to us for possible publication grows daily and we are able to select from a wealth of good material.

At this point in A.A. history, your editors feel a particular concern for the Traditions and for A.A. principles. We



RECEPTION ROOM

## DELEGATES TOUR G.S.O. GRAPEVINE

Though delegates of Panel 21 felt on familiar ground as they visited the G.S.O. and Grapevine premises Thursday afternoon during a scheduled break in the Conference sessions, Panel 22 delegates enjoyed their first "official" tour under the warm guidance of our receptionist Muriel and her capable assistants. Delegates had an opportunity to chat with the staff and office personnel, ask questions, and view at close hand the various office operations.

published 12 excellent articles on the Twelve Traditions. These, we know, have stimulated group discussion of the Traditions. We are currently running Bill W.'s Twelve Concepts for World Service. We have continued to stress A.A. thinking on our anonymity Traditions. All of this, we hope, will contribute to a better understanding of A.A.

During this year, we have been engaged in indexing all material ever published in the Grapevine since its beginning. We have completed 18 years with some 300 categories.

## WORLD SERVICE MEETING (Beth K.)

The next World Service Meeting will take place October 5-7, 1972. The General Service Board has approved a budget of \$15,000 as its share of the expense. All countries participating approved an increase from \$200 to \$300 for each of their two delegates.

In addition to the twelve countries and one zone that participated in the 1969 meeting, Sweden, Brazil and Ireland were invited. Sweden and Ireland are interested, but Brazil feels it is not yet ready.

"Our Primary Purpose" will be the meeting theme. Some of the agenda subjects will be:

1. Four-year term for delegates?
2. Worldwide publishing and literature policies.
3. Eventual preparation of a "Service Manual" for each country.
4. What constitutes G.S. Conference-approved material in each country?
5. Writings of individual members, carrying their names, as Conference-approved material?
6. Exploration of the World Service Meeting structure.
7. Review of requirements for delegates.
8. Discussion of local financial needs.

The Agenda/Admissions Committee of the World Service Meeting disapproved the request from three coun-

(cont'd. on p. 28)

# Questions and Answers from the Floor

## ANONYMITY

**Q. Are we violating the Twelve Traditions when in front of an A.A. group we say our first and last names?**

**A.** The 21st General Service Conference recommended the use of first and last names within A.A. All felt this would improve communication and thus be an aid to A.A. growth.

**Q. Should anyone connected with A.A. have his full name used in publicity at any level?**

**A.** Only non-A.A.'s at the public level.

## CENTRAL OFFICES

**Q. Is it all right for a central office to handle A.A. convention flyers that have Al-Anon functions listed on them?**

**A.** Show of hands indicated many do.

**Q. We have noticed in the World Directory that most of the central offices are listed with the town they are in, such as Central Office of (name of town). Is it advisable to list a central office with a state, such as Central Office of (name of state)? We are thinking of doing this in our state.**

**A.** If there is another central office in the state, you will probably be receiving complaints.

**Q. Could the money in the Bill Wilson Memorial Fund be used toward the purchase of a permanent location for G.S.O.—GV office, or is this a breaking of tradition? This would be owned by A.A.W.S.**

**A.** It is traditional not to own properties. One reason is that this would commit future generations of A.A.'s to an indebtedness which they might not be able to support as the years pass.

## CLUBS

**Q. What do the delegates think about a club having in its by-laws a request for all A.A. groups in a district to elect a representative to the club's steering committee?**

**A.** It was the sense of the meeting that since A.A. has no connection with clubs and therefore cannot tell them what to do, there is no way we can prevent them from putting this stipulation in their charters or bylaws. It was felt, however, that before taking such action, the clubs have the consent of all the groups concerned; though this request is entirely up to the A.A. groups, it could be interpreted as a violation of Tradition Six.

## GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

**Q. Could we have a show of hands as to how many trustees are employed by outside agencies?**

**A.** Two trustees.

**Q. How can we better inform the Fellowship of the availability of trustee speakers for conferences, with the Board paying one-half their expenses: what limit is there on the number of trips they are allowed?**

**A.** We could publicize this by running a story in *Box 4-5-9*, informing A.A.'s that their trustee can meet with them, and that the Board will absorb one-half his expenses up to \$500 a year.

## GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

**Q. a. How many areas reimburse their area officers for mileage allowance for auto trips concerned with General Service area business?**

**A.** Show of hands indicated 25 areas do.

**b. How many reimburse area committee members?**

**A.** Show of hands — twelve do.

**Q. Why doesn't the chairman chair the meetings only, leaving the reporting and opinions to those who are on the agenda for the purpose?**

**A.** There is considerable merit in this suggestion. The more people involved in the Conference, the better.

**Q. There are many new groups being formed whose members don't have much time on the program. They hesitate to elect a G.S.R. because none of them has had two or three years in A.A. as recommended in the A.A. Service Manual. Wouldn't it be wise to change the Manual and make allowances for such conditions? It's better to have a G.S.R. without much time on the program than to have none at all.**

**A.** Everything about the A.A. program and structure is suggested only; so, too, is everything in the A.A. Service Manual—it's up to the group.

**Q. How many areas have a combined secretary/treasurer for their assemblies, as compared to an individual secretary and treasurer?**

**A.** Show of hands indicated about six have a combined secretary/treasurer of their assemblies.

**Q. By a show of hands, how many delegates are presently sponsoring someone in our Fellowship?**

A. Overwhelming majority.

**Q. My area gave me a check for \$75, plus the \$150 to N.Y. How do other areas work this? Do you feel this is too much? Not too much, or unnecessary?**

A. The answers were varied. Allowances ranged from \$50 to \$250, and some areas gave their delegates a yearly allowance, and some had an almost unlimited expense allowance. Delegates are advised to explain to their areas what is involved, what the needs and expenses are, why they should be at the Conference, etc.

**Q. We have 15 districts, 5 metropolitan and 10 rural. The committee members, of course, are voted in by the G.S.R.'s of their district. The committee members then are the only voting members at the assembly level. This has almost completely stopped "cliques." For instance, a clique of G.S.R.'s in a section of the metropolitan area cannot control the assembly. Are we following the Third Legacy with this structure of voting?**

A. Our A.A. Service Manual says that at assemblies, G.S.R.'s and committee members are allowed to vote and if they are not doing so, they are not conforming to the suggestions in the A.A. Service Manual.

**Q. What can be done if an area treasurer persists in ignoring the delegate on matters affecting the area?**

A. It is up to the area to iron out these local problems.

## GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE

**Q. Is G.S.O. leaning towards promotion rather than attraction?**

A. No.

**Q. Our area asked to *purchase* a copy of the film, "Bill Discusses the Traditions," but were denied. It was said, "It would weaken our copyright." Why? How?**

A. Our attorney has advised us we should not sell this film. We would lose all control over it if we did so, and could have nothing to say about audiences to which it is shown.

**Q. What happened to the universal nationwide phone number originally proposed?**

A. G.S.O. is continuing to explore this possibility. (Since the Conference, we have explored the universal nationwide phone number and have found the cost prohibitive.)

**Q. If possible, could you briefly explain the Pension Fund presently in force at G.S.O.?**

A. The plan is a non-contributory career average plan and is available to every G.S.O. and GV employee who works full time, or at least twenty hours per week and has completed at least three years of service and has attained his 30th but not his 64th birthday.

**Q. Can Box 4-5-9 have space to list changes of group contact for G.S.O. records to keep data more current?**

A. This would be mechanically impossible since we have many thousands of changes.

**Q. Does A.A. have a current estimate of percent of people who after coming to A.A. (1) do not drink again, (2) slip but later maintain sobriety, and (3) never come back?**

A. Information on numbers one and two can be found in the 1968 Survey pamphlet. However, we don't have any estimates on number three and don't know where we could get any.

**Q. Are we going to have a recent picture of Bill W. available?**

A. We have one taken two years ago which could be made available. Those who have seen it have mixed feelings about it. We would hesitate to send it out since the buyer might not be pleased.

## GRAPEVINE

**Q. Why does Victor E. of Grapevine fame continually hang around the barroom doors?**

A. We have been acting as sponsors to Victor for about nine years. He lives A.A. and thinks this is a way of life, but he can't quite accept the idea that one drink is the one that does it. But so far something has happened to divert him and he has been able to walk away and remain sober for the next 24 hours. That way he has had nine years of sobriety. Seriously, I think what we're trying to say here is that when a newcomer starts coming around, or even some who have been around a while, start thinking of drinking, that if there is something that can divert him from this thought, chances are he can walk away and stay sober. Like a telephone or a candy bar, etc. One of these days Victor will get into the program and I won't have to draw him any more.

**Q. Although it clearly states in the front of the Grapevine that there is no endorsement, why is the section entitled "About Alcoholism" necessary, especially when so many of the items are not in line with our program? What is *implied* is so important in this Fellowship.**

A. The reason we do have articles about alcoholism in the back is because of the increasing requests of our readership. From the first issue in 1944, there has been information on what is current in the field of alcoholism and in September 1966, we at the Grapevine decided to digest certain articles that were sent to us. All the material comes from A.A.'s and we have a great deal of response from this material and gratitude for the information.

**Q. Why is the Grapevine not published in Spanish?**

A. Words mean different things to different people in different places and a translation that satisfied and pleased

(cont'd. on p. 24)

everybody would be financially and technically impossible for the Grapevine.

Rather, the Grapevine would encourage local area or even national entities to create their own magazines. In such cases the Grapevine stands ready to cooperate to the fullest extent and would grant permission to translate and print copyrighted Grapevine material.

We would hope that other countries would stimulate interest among local A.A.'s, as we have done here, so that their own culture would be reflected in their magazine. This has now been done in the Finnish and French languages. They use articles from the Grapevine but they also encourage their own people to write articles and contribute to their own magazine. This kind of sharing and participation helps keep A.A. growing and strong wherever it may be.

### GROUP AFFAIRS

**Q. If we have never taken any sort of drugs are we capable of talking to a person on drugs?**

A. At the Conference, a show of hands indicated several delegates felt that we could not share experience with drug users.

**Q. Various statements are voiced by speakers in their opening remarks: "I am an alcoholic," "I am a recovering alcoholic," "I am a recovered alcoholic"... which is right?**

A. This is a personal thing.

**Q. What guidelines do most groups use as a basis of membership reporting? That is, attendance, sobriety, etc.?**

A. The smaller and more isolated the group, the more accurate the count. In large metropolitan areas, the figures we get are seldom based on actual lists of members. Many groups do not keep attendance records. The attendance figures reported are the group's best estimate.

**Q. What is the thinking of the Conference on obscenity at meetings?**

A. Most don't like it anytime, anyplace. However, we can't tell anyone what to say. Only twelve delegates indicated by show of hands that this is a problem in their areas.

**Q. At last year's Conference there was a suggestion that February 14 or the month of February be recognized as a special day or period for Bill and all the others who have left us. Can we discuss this now?**

A. The overwhelming majority felt that February 14 or the month of February should not be recognized as a special memorial day or period.

**Q. There is a statement in many of our groups that has become widely used: "The Big Book, 'Alcoholics Anonymous,' is the only authority in A.A." Is this statement accurate? What authority is there in A.A.?**

A. The authority in A.A. is the group conscience.

**Q. I go to two different groups and celebrate my birthday in both. I was elected chairman in one group and treasurer in the other at the same time. Am I doing wrong? Right? Please advise.**

A. It is suggested in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet that a member not hold office in more than one group at the same time.

### PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

**Q. By a show of hands, how many delegates believe in co-operation with outside agencies?**

A. Unanimously believe A.A. should cooperate with outside agencies.

**Q. Are there any delegates here who are directors of Alcoholism and Drug Councils or programs?**

A. Show of hands: 10 delegates indicated they are directors.

### PUBLIC INFORMATION

**Q. Should the Serenity Prayer and/or the Lord's Prayer be used at public meetings?**

A. Show of hands indicated an overwhelming majority felt they should.

**Q. The Public Information Committee report left me with a feeling that we are starting to promote A.A. to the public. Is this the intention of the committee?**

A. No. The chairman was merely informing us what had been done by that committee. He talked about public information in general. The P.I. Committee follows the guidelines which the Conference has given it.

### STEPS

**Q. In an area, some groups seem not to regard the Steps of prime importance. Is this an isolated incident or a change that is happening in A.A.?**

A. Show of hands: three or four showed less emphasis today on the Steps.



# Reports Show A.A. Growing in Size and Strength

## REPORT OF CHAIRMAN

Judging by reports given by regional and general service trustees at our quarterly meetings, from sales of books and pamphlets and from correspondence, A.A. is growing in size and strength. So, at the moment, A.A. is, in your Board's opinion, in excellent shape, although we are somewhat concerned that group contributions are still substantially below the cost of group services.

Several writers approached us regarding a biography of Bill. One was finally selected, Bob T., an A.A. member who was favored by both Bill and Lois. He is currently proceeding with the work.

The Board has also been faced with the question of what to do with the memorial contributions sent by A.A. members from all parts of the world. These have been set aside in a special fund which has reached approximately \$36,000. Several suggestions have been considered. We have a feeling there is no hurry to make a decision; that when the right thing comes along, the group conscience will make itself heard.

The Board recommended that plaques not be placed on Bill's and Dr. Bob's birthplaces; and that Lois not allow Bill's name to be used in connection with a proposed William G. Wilson Memorial Alcoholism Research Foundation.

Some members felt very strongly that their group should be known as the "Bill Wilson Group." This was forwarded to the Conference as an agenda item.

The Board also agreed to forward to the Conference a proposal to combine the Board's General Fund and the Group Fund into one operating Fund, thus simplifying our accounting.

The Board approved Denver, Colorado, as the site of the 1975 International Convention. It also suggested that some sort of correspondence be developed between nonalcoholic trustees representing Boards in different parts of the world.

*John L. Norris, M.D., chairman  
General Service Board of A.A.*

## POLICY

(Bill C., chairman)

This committee meets on the Sunday before the meeting of the General Service Board. All trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members and members of all the Trustees' Committees are invited to these meetings. Some 40-45 people are in attendance.

The Policy Committee hears reports of the G.S. Board committee chairmen, approves the theme for the General Service Conference, discusses Conference Agenda items and recommends their approval to the Board, draws the names of new delegates for service on the ten Conference Committees . . . the Policy Committee also provides staff and committee members with news of what is happening throughout the U.S. and Canada as each regional trustee delivers a report on his area.

Among subjects discussed at length at Policy meetings this past year were:

1. A.A.'s possible acceptance of Step-ing Stones in joint ownership with Al-Anon.
2. Bill's biography.
3. Bill's Memorial Fund.
4. Anonymity and the anonymity Tradition.

## FINANCE AND BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

(Arthur Miles, chairman)

Overall, the financial picture of G.S.O. for 1971 was quite good. Sales, one of our important growth indicators, showed a net increase of \$147,300 over 1970 or 28%. Contributions, another good indicator of growth, totaled \$498,800 for the year, which was \$33,800 more than forecast and \$64,200 more than received in 1970, a 15% increase. Excluding net income from the 1970 Convention, total income, i.e., publishing gross profit and contributions, increased \$148,800 over the year 1970, or an in-

crease of 20%. Total expenses, excluding costs related to moving the office, increased \$99,500, up 13% but within 4% of the budget. The expense increase was directly related to the growth of the Fellowship, the communications expenses incurred in relation to Bill's death and the ever-increasing cost of doing business.

In summary, the \$23,400 deficit of the Group Fund and the General Fund expense which totaled \$57,900 were offset by A.A. World Services, Inc. publishing net income which amounted to \$115,200. This left G.S.O. with a net income \$33,900 for the year 1971.

The G.S.O. budget for 1972 has been reviewed and approved by the General Service Board Finance Committee. It is a prudent one and allows for increases in both income and expense. Total income, consisting of contributions and gross profit from sales, is budgeted 7.7% higher than 1971 actual income. Because of the many possible factors responsible for the unusually large increase in income for 1971, rather than anticipate the same increase for 1972, the budgeted amount is based on the expected growth rate of A.A. for the coming year. Total expenses are budgeted 9.7% higher than 1971 actual expenses. This allows for an increase in postal rates and increased publishing activity; an allowance to cover the cost of the World Service Meeting to be held this fall; and an increase in other expenses to allow for growth and the higher cost of doing business. Net income from all G.S.O. operations is expected to total \$17,900.

The Fellowship's Tradition of self-support is indeed unique. However, because of this Tradition, it becomes vitally important that all A.A. groups and members carry their full share of the cost of our worldwide services. With full participation, the goals, dignity and strength of A.A. will be insured.

## LITERATURE

(Austin MacCormick, chairman)

Work that has gone on with the co-operation of the Conference Literature  
(cont'd. on p. 26)

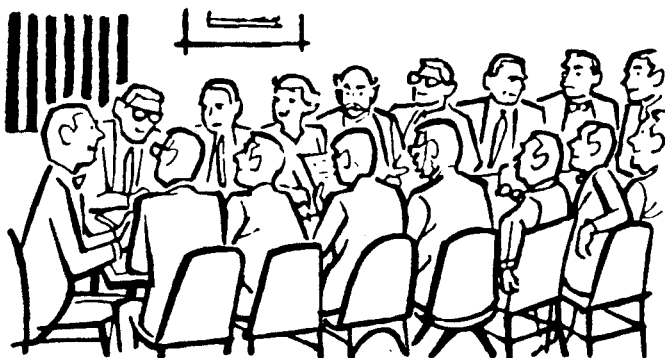
Committee since the committee's 1971 report to the Conference includes:

1. "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" is now in circulation and has been enthusiastically received. To date 25,000 copies have gone out.
2. The leaflet of the biographies of Dr. Bob and Bill has been completed and is now available..
3. Revision of the booklet, "How We Stay Sober" (working title) is now in the hands of the consultant to the Literature Committee.
4. Bill's Grapevine article, "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends," has been added to the Order Blank in addition to his two Grapevine articles, "Problems Other Than Alcohol" and "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous."
5. "Came to Believe" is still being worked on. Stories that are more inclusive of the spiritual as it is experienced in the total A.A. way of life are being sought, and it was agreed that the Grapevine be included as a source of material.
6. The suggestion that the Grapevine carry an article on the Big Book was adopted and it appeared in the March issue.
7. Material concerning A.A. in small towns has been prepared and will appear in the next run of the "A.A. Group."
8. "A.A. in the Armed Services" is still awaiting additional stories.
9. The committee approved the discontinuation of the "Fortune Story."
10. The Foreword to the Service Manual entitled "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" has been added to the Literature Order Blank.

### LONG-RANGE PLANNING COMMITTEE

(Dr. John Norris, chairman)

This committee was formed two years ago to help us recognize and deal with changing conditions and events which may face our Fellowship in future years.



### THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

This is a small group, which encourages creative thinking and freewheeling discussion. Additional A.A. members, professionals in the alcoholism field and others are brought in from time to time so that new ideas can be heard and discussed.

Our last meeting included a discussion of group dynamics and special purpose meetings in A.A., whether there is a real need for them, how many different types there are, etc. The consensus was there might be a real need, that it might offer a way to keep the interest of old-timers and others who drift away.

Everyone agreed there seems to be a need to make regular meetings more interesting so we can all get the help we require.

The importance of making a distinction between specialized meetings and specialized groups was emphasized. Specialized meetings geared to study the Steps, explore problems in depth, or seek closer contact with the Higher Power are fine, but specialized groups with restricted membership may be dangerous.

It was felt to be a good idea to encourage more discussion within the Fellowship regarding different types of meetings held in different areas so whoever wishes can try new formats. The Grapevine, Box 4-5-9 and other inter-A.A. communication tools can be used for this purpose.

There was also discussion, at another meeting, of the need to help establish A.A. better with minority groups, the professional in the alcoholism field, problems of older A.A. members and anonymity, among others.

One non-A.A. guest, C.H. Aharan, regional director of the Alcoholism and Drug Addiction Research Foundation, Ontario, Canada, suggested we may be running into a problem in reverse with regard to the disease concept, that if too much emphasis is placed on this point a tendency naturally develops to refer alcoholics to professionals and facilities which are concerned with the treatment of other diseases. He felt this is a growing tendency among A.A. members, suggested A.A.'s stay with the drunk rather than just referring him to some sort of professional facility for treatment. There is no problem in getting people sober, he said, it is *keeping* them sober that is difficult.

### NOMINATING COMMITTEE

(Robert P., chairman)

This committee recommended to the General Service Board:

1. That the following slate of officers and directors of the Grapevine Corporate Board be elected by that Board:

Milton Maxwell: President, Chairman  
Paula C.: Vice President, Secretary  
George G.: Treasurer

#### Directors

|                   |           |
|-------------------|-----------|
| Ralph A.          | Jack M.   |
| Charles E.        | Robert P. |
| Austin MacCormick | Peter S.  |

2. That Joseph H., Jr. and Thomas C. be elected directors of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

3. That Ralph A., submitted by the Grapevine Corporate Board, be elected president and chairman of that Board.

4. That George G., submitted by the Grapevine Corporate Board for Class B general service trustee, effective August 1, 1972, be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board, following presentation to the 1972 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

5. That Niles P., submitted by A.A.W.S., for Class B general service trustee, effective January 1, 1972, be elected at the quarterly meeting of the General Service Board in November, following a mail poll of all Conference members for disapproval, if any. The mail poll response expressed approval of Niles for general service trustee.

6. That the following slate of trustee candidates be presented for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1972 Conference for disapproval, if any:

#### Class A

|                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| John Norris, M.D.  | Vincent Dole, M.D. |
| John Bealer, M.D.  | Austin MacCormick  |
| Travis Dancy, M.D. | Milton Maxwell     |
| Arthur Miles       |                    |

#### Class B

|           |                 |
|-----------|-----------------|
| Ralph A.  | Thomas M.       |
| Donald A. | Stephen O., Sr. |
| Thomas G. | Robert P. (thru |
| George G. | July 1972)      |
| James H.  | Niles P.        |
| Jack M.   | Robert R.       |

- 1 Class B regional trustee, Northeast (years to serve - 3)
- 1 Class B regional trustee, West Central (years to serve - 4)
- 1 Class B regional trustee, Western Canada (years to serve - 4)
- 1 Class B general service trustee (GV - years to serve - 4)

7. That the following slate of officers, presented by the General Service Board, be elected at the annual meeting of the members in April, 1972:

John Norris, M.D.: Chairman  
Austin MacCormick: 1st Vice Chm.  
Robert R.: 2nd Vice Chairman  
George G.: Secretary  
Arthur Miles: Treasurer  
Midge M.: Assistant Secretary  
Dennis Manders: Ass't Treasurer

8. That the following director candidates of A.A.W.S., Inc. be elected at the annual meeting of the members of A.A.W.S., Inc., in April

|             |                 |
|-------------|-----------------|
| Robert H.   | Stephen O., Sr. |
| Robert Mac. | Robert P. (thru |
| Midge M.    | July 1972)      |
| Walter M.   | Niles P.        |

The committee discussed again whether it is a good idea for a delegate to the Conference to be proposed as a trustee candidate before his term as delegate has expired. It was recommended to the Conference Committee on Trustees that a delegate to the Conference shall not be eligible to be proposed for trustee candidate until after he has attended his last Conference because experience has shown: (1) there is danger if the delegate is also a trustee candidate, it may make it difficult for him to concentrate on matters relating to his duties and responsibilities as a delegate, and (2) that there is also a danger it may impose a hardship on that particular candidate, as many delegates disapproval of a delegate being a trustee candidate while still serving as delegate.

The committee reviewed the G.S.O. resume sheet used for regional trustee and general service trustees (U.S. and Canada); and suggested that the trustee candidate sign and date the resume, attesting to the accuracy of the information given to the best of his knowledge and belief.

The committee recommended that as new Conference committees are formed, the number of committee members on the Trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees always be identical.

All 25 regional Class B trustee candidates for the three electing regions (W. Central, Northeast, and Western Canada) were found eligible for consideration.

### PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS (Steve O., chairman)

In October, a model of the new Professional Exhibit, for which this committee was asked to make suggestions on design, was displayed and accepted. It is now in circulation. The committee had discussions concerning effective manning of the exhibit where it is shown, feeling

it should always be handled by local A.A.'s—the delegate or former delegate—wherever possible. Otherwise, members of the local P.I.C., or central office will be asked to provide volunteers; G.S.O. will provide suggestions and information for the chairman and volunteers. Also G.S.O. will notify the delegate when the exhibit is being shown in his area.

The committee suggested we contact professional agencies, expressing our interest in showing the Exhibit and our willingness to provide an A.A. speaker for their conventions, which has been done in several instances; for example, at the meeting of N.A.A.A.P. in Hartford, Conn. last year, Bayard P. read a paper on A.A. that was well received.

The new pamphlet for Professionals in the Alcoholic Field was reviewed, which is directed to individuals who may not be as familiar with A.A. and its Traditions as we think, individuals such as doctors, clergymen, psychologists, educators, correction officers, nurses, armed forces officers, law-enforcement officials, etc.

The committee suggested preparation of two new sets of Guidelines: for "A.A. Members Employed in the Field of Alcoholism (those who were 'two hats') and for "A.A. Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities."

A mailing list has been prepared for a Newsletter going to professionals to keep them informed on A.A.'s activities, new pamphlets, etc. The first one will be mailed shortly after the Conference.

Also discussed was the question of A.A. participation in surveys and research projects by outside agencies or individuals. It was felt these were local problems to be decided locally, but suggested special guidelines be prepared, emphasizing that: we are not opposed to research and are grateful for the interest of those outside A.A.; any individual A.A. is free, of course, to participate in any project he chooses; A.A. meetings traditionally are devoted exclusively to the A.A. program; most A.A. groups have not distributed questionnaires or arranged for interviews during meeting time (some have done so *after* meetings); central offices can put researchers in touch with A.A.'s who are willing to participate in such projects; perhaps a

(cont'd. on p. 28)

committee or subcommittee, made up of A.A.'s who are interested, could take responsibility for finding others who would be so inclined.

As A.A. is the primary community resource for alcoholics, the committee feels it is important to try and establish good communication between A.A.'s where the programs are located and the individuals administering these programs.

### PUBLIC INFORMATION

(Walter M., chairman)

The Trustees' P.I. Committee worked in many ways during the past year to carry the A.A. message and provide information about the Fellowship to the public:

#### Accomplishments

1. The Anonymity Wallet Card, the Student's Guide to A.A. and the Position Paper on Anonymity are in distribution.

2. Updated Guidelines on "How A.A. Cooperates During Alcoholism Information Month," distributed Guidelines on "Industry Programs" and "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends."

3. Mailed the Annual Report to the Public and the Anonymity Letter to the Press to 3,000 newspapers and radio and TV stations.

4. Ready for distribution: the new P.I. Manual. Background Radio/TV Material has been updated.

5. A new letter to the press, using Anonymity Letter to the Press as a model, was prepared with a brief cover letter to the A.A. member whose anonymity had been broken.

6. Distributed press release regarding Dr. Norris' trip to Germany.

#### Projects in Progress

1. New leaflet on anonymity which should clear up some of the confusion on this subject. In it the writer quotes Bill frequently and often cites A.A. Conference-approved literature.

2. New color-TV public service announcements still in preparation.

3. Discussion on advisability of having a press luncheon just before World Service Meeting, is continuing

4. Hope to share more P.I. activities with overseas A.A. Boards—we will send them the bimonthly P.I. Bulletin.

#### Projects for the Future

1. We are exploring possibility of a major magazine article on A.A.

2. Also discussing a motion picture about A.A. which could be useful for TV and public meetings.

3. According to preliminary findings of the 1971 survey, we need to find new and better ways of reaching young people.

### 1975 CONVENTION

Denver, Colorado, was selected by the Convention Site Committee at the 1971 Conference to host A.A.'s 40th Anniversary and International Convention in 1975. This 6th International A.A. Convention, like all the others will mark another milestone in the history of A.A.

The Host Committee has opened up an account for the guarantee fund in a Denver bank.

All Convention activities will be housed in the Currigan Convention Complex. Hot meals and sandwiches will be served cafeteria-style in Currigan Hall, which will also have two snack bars open during sessions.

Jack M., a former Colorado delegate, has agreed to serve as Host Committee chairman and John N., current delegate, is also serving on the committee.

The Brown Palace Hotel will serve as Convention headquarters; the Denver Hilton Hotel as headquarters hotel for Al-Anon and Alateen.

—Bob H., *Conv. Chairman*

### MORE ABOUT THE CONVENTION

Enthusiasm in Colorado is tremendously high about this '75 Convention. Presently we're engaged in securing the Guarantee Fund—we already have 35% of it and we anticipate no problems.

An area you'll be interested in is housing: we have more than the 5,000-room guarantee, first-class, air-conditioned hotel rooms. By 1975 there will be approximately 1,000 to 1,200 new, first-class hotel rooms, one of which will be 1½ blocks from the Convention center. Also, the dormitories of Denver University will provide a lot of additional housing units.

—John N., *Colorado*

Currigan Hall will seat about 14,000 people; there's not a column in the whole building to obstruct the view. Many of the hotels are within walking distance of the Convention center, where all meetings will be held. The University of Denver has high-rise dormitories, private baths in each room and these will be available most economically. Because of the food concessions in the Convention complex, you can go and stay all day without having to leave.

—Jim H., *general service trustee, U.S.*

### WORLD SERVICE MEETING

(from p. 21)

tries to have observers attend the meeting.

The aims and purposes of the World Service Meeting are the same as those of this Conference . . . to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. The major objectives of this meeting are: (1) to consider future development of world services, (2) to strengthen general service work already existing overseas, (3) to increase the number of service centers, (4) to provide for them an orderly plan of evolution and (5) to assist and strengthen them in their self-support. Delegates will discuss these objectives in a series of workshops, round-table discussions and presentations, with those in more advanced areas sharing their experience with those just starting off.

Major subjects for discussion will be in the areas of printing and distribution of A.A. literature and establishing of literature distribution centers.

—Niles P., *general service trustee, N.Y.*

# Conference Seen as Group Conscience at Work

The closing session of the 1972 Conference, no less than in other years, was a time of summing up. It was also a moment when the purposes and processes of the Conference were most clearly understood and reaffirmed. It was, especially, a time to bid au revoir to trusted and devoted servants, and we listened with affection to these rotating trustees as they shared with us their stories, experience and thoughts for A.A.'s future.

But first, Bob McA., the Area Delegates' chairman, shared this thought with the Conference: This has been a wonderful experience for me. I have been able to feel the group conscience at work; I think we all have.

"When we go home, we have a responsibility to the next delegate; we owe it to him to prepare him as best we can, so we can have better Conferences. Tom G. touched on it when he talked about trying to get the best people to find their way to the Conference. Somebody said that the G.S.R. is the temporary sponsor of the group and to me this is what A.A. is all about . . . the flow of information from the G.S.R. to here; it is our responsibility to report to the best of our ability what has gone on here.

And Don F., outgoing regional trustee from the West Central region, said: "This is my sixth Conference. Something happens at each of these Conferences; each one seems a little greater than the previous one. There's a light and sparkle and vitality here that I've seen nowhere else. I've had a privilege and opportunity that few people in A.A. have and I'm most grateful to all of you."

Bob P., outgoing general service trustee, New York, shared his A.A. story and then said: "I see my involvement coming to an end three months from now, leaving an enormous void in my life. It's not a sad time, however; in fact, it is a happy time. I'll be going back to my own group in which I have never stopped being active and paying attention to my own personal sobriety, and I think this is going to be just as rewarding as having been involved in all the service aspects of the Fellowship.

## HOSPITALITY COMMITTEE

While delegates applied themselves to the business of the 1972 Conference, their wives and husbands enjoyed an interesting and diversified tour of "our town," thanks to Adelyne M.'s tireless and dedicated Hospitality Committee volunteers. The visitors looked in on Al-Anon Headquarters, the New York Intergroup and visited the studio of artist Richard Seyffert, shopped at Macy's, toured Lincoln Center and the U.N., attended a Broadway matinee, visited a fashion showroom to name only a few of their activities. The Hospitality Room at the Roosevelt Hotel, staffed by volunteers, was open each day for visitors.

"A thought I'd like to leave is this: in bringing your group problems here, getting them in your teeth and shaking them which is exactly what you should do, I hope you won't become so involved with all these trees and branches that you lose sight of the wonderful forest that we have here. We talk about how the rise of clubs, the relaxation of anonymity, the wearing of 'two hats' will ruin A.A. But nothing will ruin A.A., it will survive and grow and be healthy because it exists by the grace of God and no other way. I hope we will examine everything we do and make sure of our motivation, being sure it is not a subconscious grabbing for power or a feeling of ego that comes from having exerted leadership. We are nothing but trusted servants. You're the servants of the groups; the trustees are nothing but your servants.

## A VISIT TO "STEPPING STONES"

A visit to Bill and Lois's home in Bedford Hills, N.Y. scheduled every other year, has long been an enjoyable feature of the Conference weeks activities. At the close of the last session, Saturday p.m. delegates boarded buses for the hour and half drive to "Stepping Stones." There they had a rare opportunity to talk with Lois, visit Bill's studio and eat a delicious buffet lunch before returning to New York—then home!

This is the feeling that must survive in A.A. and by which A.A. will survive."

And Bill C., outgoing regional trustee from the Northeast region: "We've had a beautiful meeting, an honest one. We looked at ourselves and at what we haven't done and this is necessary for we no longer have Bill's guidance.

"Panel 15 (my panel) was a memorable one. Dr. Jack and Bill gave talks on the change in structure of the Board and there was much discussion. A beautiful phrase was given to us that day, 'Take it back to your areas for a year and let the fire go out and the light come in.' I did take the question back to my area and in the meantime, we had the Toronto Convention out of which came the "I Am Responsible" declaration. I felt we had become responsible. The next year at the Delegates Only meeting, there was much heated debate about this ratio question and then the wisdom came through, emotional wisdom. That Conference was a growing up for me and I like to think it made me a different person.

"I leave here with mixed feelings, of sadness but also of joy, of having been enriched by you people . . ."

John R., outgoing regional trustee from Western Canada, was not able to be present at the Conference because of illness, but he shared by letter: "My term has been a tremendous experience, it has given me a keener look into the total area of our structure.

"There are two or three things I'd like to suggest delegates pass on to committee members and G.S.R.'s; first, an understanding of the importance of our Conference-approved literature, including the Grapevine, and its usefulness in meeting group needs; seeing to it that our new pamphlet, 'A Brief Guide to A.A.' gets into the hands of our friends the doctors, psychiatrists, clergymen, etc.; third, holding of area G.S.R. assemblies regularly, particularly workshops on General Service.

"I feel we all have a tremendous responsibility . . . to hold the torch high so that those in darkness will be able to look up and see the light."

# Conference Committees Reports

The following reports were presented to the Conference by Committee Chairmen and their acceptance by the delegates constituted Advisory Actions of the Conference.

## AGENDA/ADMISSIONS COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Agenda/Admissions recommended that:

1. In an area submitting an application for an additional delegate, such application be received by G.S.O. not later than January 1, preceding the Conference.
2. The following be added to the application for additional delegate:
  - a. What could another delegate do that more committee members could not do?
  - b. A map showing areas as they will exist if a new delegate is allowed.
3. The request from the B.C./Yukon area for an additional delegate be held in abeyance for another year pending further information and reconsideration during the year.
4. The matter of the application for an additional delegate from the Province of Quebec be tabled for a period of one year, and be returned to the Agenda/Admissions Committee with the following information:
  - a. A new map showing areas as they now exist.
  - b. A map showing areas as they will exist if a new delegate is allowed.
  - c. Show where area meetings are being held in 1972; how each delegate is elected and how he reports to his area, bearing in mind the suggestions in the A.A. Service Manual.
  - d. Suggest that they also redistrict their areas, using more committee members from smaller districts as suggested in the A.A. Service Manual.
5. We follow the guidelines that we set up at last year's Conference: that the A.A. meeting on Monday night be retained, and that in even years we have delegate participation, and in odd years, we have G.S.O. and Grapevine staff participation for short talks with a delegate chairman. This format to be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.
6. All motions that are to be acted upon by the delegation be, *as much as possible*, submitted in writing beforehand, and if time permits, be distributed to the delegates by mail.

7. Delegate participation in some way be scheduled on Monday.
8. Suggested agenda item: A scheduled workshop on inactive members be on the agenda for the 1973 Conference, and that there be no outline material (no scheduled questions).
9. Elected Lou D., No. Illinois, as new chairman.

## CONFERENCE POLICY COMMITTEE

The Committee on Conference Policy recommended that:

1. A deadline be specified on the return of all questionnaires sent to delegates.
2. Because G.S.O. has given each delegate a questionnaire at this year's Conference, the Committee on Conference Policy not make a Conference evaluation this year, but next year review the success or failure of this year's method, and determine the method to be used in future Conferences.
3. All Conference Committee agendas continue to be sent to all delegates.
4. The Conference reaffirm the 1969 Conference Agenda/admissions Committee recommendation "that when an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined by the A.A. Service Manual) that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties."
5. The agenda of the Conference be structured so that all Conference Committee reports be in the hands of the delegates by Friday morning.
6. Elected Archie M., West Michigan, as new chairman.

## CONFERENCE REPORT & CHARTER COMMITTEE

The Conference Report and Charter Committee recommended that:

1. Wherever the term "trustees at large" appears in the A.A. Service Manual, the wording should be changed to "general service trustee, United States" and "general service trustee, Canada" in line with the Board's recommendation for change in its bylaws as accepted by this Conference.
2. Any future changes to be considered in the Conference Charter or A.A. Service Manual be brought to the attention of the committee's chairman through the secretary, for the sharing of this information before it is finally adopted.

3. The Literature Committee consider combining the summaries of the Ask-it-Basket Questions and the Advisory Actions into a single looseleaf binder, and, as such, be offered to groups and members as a salable item.
4. Agreed to return the completed draft of the Conference Report one week from date of its receipt.
5. Elected Don O., So. Indiana, as the new chairman.

## FINANCE COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Finance recommended that:

1. The Group Contribution Fund be combined with the General Fund. This fund is to be utilized for all expenses of the General Service Office, including those formerly charged to both the General Fund and Group Fund and to be known as the General Fund.
2. Groups be informed as to how and where they can contribute as well as why they should contribute.
3. Delegates explain contribution needs to their committee members and to their groups.
4. Our regular contribution plan be continued with particular emphasis on non-participating groups.
5. A finance packet or kit be sent to all committee members and area chairmen. This kit to include a package of money folders, group contribution and birthday envelopes.
6. The limit on individual gifts and bequests be increased from \$200 to \$300 per year.
7. Elected Jim H., Alberta, Canada, as new chairman.

## GRAPEVINE COMMITTEE

The Conference Grapevine Committee recommended that:

1. Retiring delegates continue their service to A.A. by acting as Grapevine Representatives in their areas.
2. Areas be encouraged to invite the Grapevine staff to visit state and provincial conferences.
3. The Grapevine resume its annual presentation to the Conference.
4. Elected George D., Saskatchewan, as new chairman.

## INSTITUTIONS COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Institutions recommended that:

1. The Literature Committee re-examine the Institutions literature in an attempt to reach all levels of understanding.

2. The possibility of a Trustees' Committee on Institutions be considered.
3. Elected Red D., Arizona, as new chairman.

## LITERATURE COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Literature recommended that:

1. The Conference delegates continue to seek material of a spiritual nature for the proposed booklet, "Came to Believe."
2. The delegates be asked to look for members willing to write their stories for the proposed pamphlet, "A.A. and the Armed Services."
3. G.S.O. be asked to submit suggestions for material and costs in reference to taped literature to the Conference Literature Committee for their recommendations. Deadline—June 1, 1972.
4. No deletions be made at this time on the G.S.O. Order Blank.
5. Suggestions for meeting discussion be included in the Group Handbook, using discussion subjects from the A.A. Grapevine, if permission is granted.
6. The Group Inventory material submitted to the Committee be recommended to G.S.O. as possible service material.
7. A cartoon leaflet on service responsibilities be considered by A.A.W.S.
8. The 24-Hour Book not be confirmed as Conference-approved literature.
9. It be suggested that when a local A.A. facility (central office, intergroup, group, etc.) sells non-Conference-approved literature, it be clearly designed as such.
10. G.S.O. review the content of *Box 4-5-9* with the idea of making the material in it more like the kind of information now included in the *Quarterly Report*.
11. Elected Henry W., Mississippi, as new chairman.

## PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS COMMITTEE

The Conference Committee on Professional Relations recommended that:

1. A.A. members approach the professional community without anxiety or fear, but with confidence that we have something to offer the alcoholic—through the professional.
2. A.A. members approach the professional with the point of view that we have a mutual interest in helping the alcoholic, and with the idea of sharing our 37 years of experience as a resource for alcoholics.

(cont'd. on p. 32)

## **ADVISORY ACTIONS**

3. The pamphlet, "If you are a Professional. . .", be approved with minor editorial changes.
4. The secretary send each member of the committee a copy of the monthly report of Professional Relations activity.
5. Elected LaVelle C., N.W. Texas, as the new chairman.

## **PUBLIC INFORMATION COMMITTEE**

The Conference Public Information Committee recommended that:

1. Special discount packages for use in schools be made available to local public information committees and other interested A.A. members.
2. Where there is no Public Information Committee, it is the delegate's responsibility to form one in his area with the help of qualified and dedicated individuals.
3. The pamphlet, "A Brief Guide to A.A." (formerly the pamphlet "A Student's Guide to A.A.") be approved.
4. Elected Sheila M., S.W. Quebec, as new chairman.

## **CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES**

The Conference Committee on Trustees recommended that:

1. The slate of members and officers of the General Service Board be accepted for the period beginning April, 1972, through April, 1973.
2. George G., submitted by the Grapevine Corporate Board, for Class B general service trustee, effective Aug. 1, 1972, be approved.
3. A delegate to the General Service Conference shall not be eligible to be proposed for trustee candidate until after he has attended his last Conference, because experience has shown that:
  - a. There is a danger that if the delegate is also a trustee candidate, it may make it difficult for him to concentrate on matters relating to his duties and responsibilities as a delegate.
  - b. That there is also a danger that it may impose a hardship on that particular candidate, as many delegates disapprove of a delegate being a trustee candidate while still serving as delegate.
4. On resume forms for Class B regional trustees, the heading "Activities Outside of A.A." include club, rehab and all alcoholism-related activities.
5. The qualifications and election procedures for Class B general service trustee, as described in the A.A. Service Manual,

be condensed with reference to the Service Manual page, and placed in *Box 4-5-9* periodically.

6. Elected Carl K., Delaware, as the new chairman.

## **OTHER CONFERENCE ACTIONS**

**NEW REGIONAL TRUSTEES ELECTED:** Junior A., Mass., Northeast region, U.S.; Jim G., Nebr., West Central region, U.S., and Matt N., Alberta, Western Canada. (See p. 41 for biographies)

**LOCAL MISUNDERSTANDINGS:** Approved the resolution: That this, the 22nd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, feels that G.S.O. should not be asked to intervene or otherwise involve itself in local disputes or misunderstandings.

**CHANGE OF REGION:** Unanimously approved the proposal to change the State of Wisconsin from the West Central region to the East Central region.

**NAMING AN A.A. GROUP AFTER AN INDIVIDUAL:** Approved the suggestion that an A.A. group should not be named after an A.A. member or nonalcoholic, living or deceased.

**A.A. GROUP POLICY RE "FAMILY" GROUPS:** Reaffirmed A.A. group policy that "Only those with a desire to stop drinking may be members of A.A. groups; only A.A. members are eligible to be officers of A.A. groups; nonalcoholics are welcome at open meetings of A.A." And, it is suggested that the word "family" not be used in the name of an A.A. group; if A.A.'s and their nonalcoholic mates wish to meet together on a regular basis, they consider these gatherings "meetings," and not A.A. groups.

**Listing in World Directory:** It was the sense of the meeting that family groups should not be listed under the family group name in the Directory.

**CLUBS:** Agreed that G.S.O. should not accept contributions from clubs, listed or known as such, whether or not composed solely of A.A. members. Contributions are welcome from groups meeting in clubs as long as they are sent in the name of the group. Letter to be sent to delegates explaining this decision so that they can inform clubs in their areas.

**"STEPPING STONES" PROPERTY:** Voted unanimously not to accept the Stepping Stones property, home of Bill and Lois.

**BILL WILSON MEMORIAL FUND:** Agreed to defer the decision on the use of the Bill Wilson Memorial Fund so that the delegates may discuss with their groups the suggestion of a film about A.A., historical or for Public Information purposes, and come back next year prepared to make a decision on this, or some other suggestion.

**CHANGE IN BYLAWS:** Approved change in bylaws to remove the words "at large" from the title of the general service trustee from the U.S. and general service trustee from Canada.

**NARCOTICS, DRUGS AND A.A.:** A show of hands indicated that more than one-half the delegates are concerned with this



problem in their areas and it was agreed that we should publicize what *we are* and *what we are not*.

**Listing in the Directory:** Unanimously agreed that alcohol and pill groups not be listed in A.A. directories or meeting lists.

**TAPE-MAKING:** Agreed that tape-making at all types of A.A. meetings with the possible exception of closed meetings, is helpful to some A.A.'s and that the decision of making tapes be left to group autonomy.

**WORLD DIRECTORY, Part I:** Recommended a set of specific guidelines on the use of the *World Directory* be prepared by G.S.O. as soon as possible. Delegates unanimously agreed that their names may be used for any referrals from G.S.O.

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## DELEGATES ONLY MEETING

The 22nd General Service Conference Area Delegates' meeting opened at 8:00 p.m., Thursday evening, April 20. The following actions were taken:

1. A contribution was made by the delegates to the memorial Fund to show gratitude to Hazel R., Betty R. and Walter H.
2. Elected two North American Conference delegates and two alternates to the World Service Meeting of 1972:

Panel 21 — delegate: Shirley S., N.E. Ohio  
                  alternate: Lenore M., E. Pennsylvania  
Panel 22 — delegate: Ben P., Kansas  
                  alternate: Ralph Z., Western New York

3. Recommended that the Area Delegate chairman should have greater Conference responsibility, and be allowed to chair parts of the meetings—such as "Personal Highlights."
4. *Strongly* recommended that the election procedure for election of trustees should be thoroughly reviewed.
5. Elected Jim H., Alberta, Canada, as next year's Area Delegates' chairman.

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## DR. NORRIS LEADS ALCOHOLISM WORKSHOPS

Last February, Dr. Norris was invited by the U.S. Army to conduct a series of workshops on alcoholism for chaplains in the U.S. Armed Services in West Germany. Meetings were held in Frankfurt, Kaiserslautern, Stuttgart, Nuernberg and Berlin.

"We began at 10 a.m. and broke up about 3 o'clock in the afternoon," he said. "In the morning I discussed the disease concept of alcoholism, and in the afternoon, talked about A.A. and the way in which chaplains and others might effectively work with A.A. G.S.O. in New York provided A.A. literature, which was left with the chaplains."

Dr. Norris said that many chaplains told him that "problems with alcohol were many times greater than those with  
(cont'd. on p. 41)

## THE BUDDY SYSTEM AT WORK

Panel 21 delegates reversed their role of last year as they took over the receiving line to greet Panel 22 members. Ably co-hosted by Pat G. (Southern Florida) and Bob McA. (West Virginia and Area Delegate chairman), the delegates' get-together got off to a swinging start on Sunday, April 16, 1972, in the Roosevelt Grill—remember the good old Guy Lombardo days?

Although it was scheduled to commence at 4 p.m., many delegates, accompanied by their respective spouses, had assembled well before the appointed hour. The room echoed with exuberant greetings, as Panel 21 renewed acquaintances and warmly welcomed the members of the new panel. In no time flat the buddy system had taken effect.

Quite a few trustees were on hand and they, too, received the same enthusiastic A.A. reception. Pat called upon delegates and trustees alike to tell in brief their A.A. stories.

Coffee was ordered and reordered, and it did not take long for the banquet department at the hotel to know that the 22nd General Service Conference was underway. The air of good will that began on that Sunday continued throughout the entire week, as it always does in the A.A. way of life.

—Kleina Jones, G.S.O.

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## LOIS' TRIP ABROAD

Lois W., having recently returned from visiting A.A. and Al-Anon groups in several countries, was a surprise guest at the Conference Friday afternoon, where she shared the highlights of her two and a half month trip. Accompanied by an Al-Anon friend, she visited groups in South Africa, Australia, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Japan and Hawaii before returning home to Bedford Hills on March 31.

"For several years, Bill and I had been hoping we could make this trip together," Lois said, "When he passed on, I thought I had better make it, that he would want me to do it. Last fall, I said to myself, 'I'd better do it right now.' It was a tremendous experience, a most inspiring thing to see A.A. and Al-Anon flourishing so vigorously all over the lower hemisphere. We can get very provincial, I think—I needed this trip to put my thinking in perspective; it did a lot for me."

The trip was planned part sight-seeing, part visiting groups, Lois said. In each place they visited, they were met by a contingent of A.A.'s and Al-Anons. Usually, there was one large joint meeting, and another smaller Al-Anon meeting.

A.A.'s, Al-Anons — and Alateens, too—welcomed Lois and Evelyn with great affection and enthusiasm in Durban, Johannesburg, Port Elizabeth, Capetown, Perth, Melbourne, Sydney, Christchurch, Rotorua, Hong Kong, Tokyo, and Honolulu.

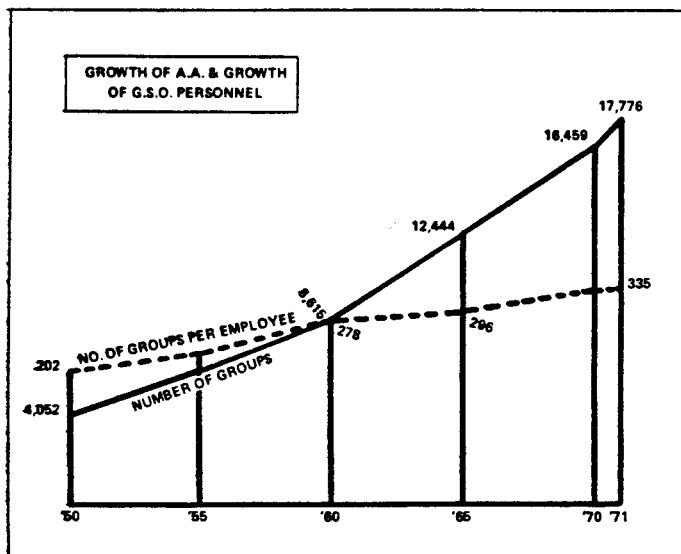
"I feel privileged to have taken this trip and it has taught me much. We hope it has helped also to broaden the views of the folks we happened to see."

# Growth & Money at G.S.O.

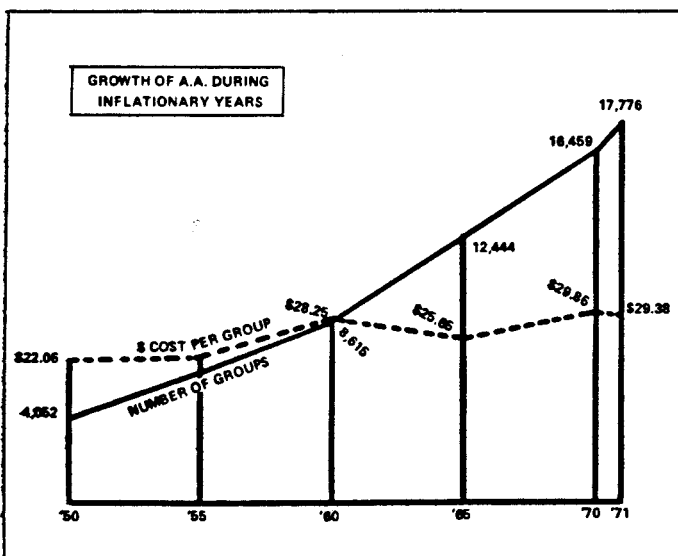
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel – in 1950 there was one employee for each 202 groups. Today, one employee serves each 335 groups.

During the past twenty one years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$89,500 to \$522,200 for services charged to the group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 72%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$22.06 to \$17.06.

|      | Groups | Employees | Groups per Employee | \$ Cost per Group | Living Cost |
|------|--------|-----------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------|
| 1950 | 4,052  | 20        | 202                 | \$22.06           | 100         |
| 1955 | 6,249  | 27        | 230                 | 22.81             | 107         |
| 1960 | 8,615  | 31        | 278                 | 28.25             | 119         |
| 1965 | 12,444 | 42        | 296                 | 25.65             | 126         |
| 1971 | 17,776 | 53        | 335                 | 29.38             | 172         |



1. (Above) There are more than 4 times as many groups today as in 1950. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 335 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 202 in 1950.



2. (Above) During the years 1950 through 1971, the cost of living increased 72 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$29.38 in 1971 compared with \$22.06 in 1950, an increase of only 33 percent.

# 1972 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1972 Operations of G.S.O. activities – Exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine – is as follows:

## BUDGET

### A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

#### INCOME

|                         |            |
|-------------------------|------------|
| Sales                   | \$733,900* |
| Less: Cost of Products  | 311,900    |
| Gross Profit from Sales | 422,000    |

#### TOTAL EXPENSES

|                            |         |
|----------------------------|---------|
| Excess of Income (Expense) | 130,600 |
|----------------------------|---------|

\*Based upon the sale of:

- 74,600 Books – “Alcoholics Anonymous”
- 29,300 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Reg.)
- 9,700 Books – “12 Steps & 12 Traditions” (Pocket)
- 9,100 Books – “A.A. Comes of Age”
- 14,900 Books – “As Bill Sees It”
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

### OFFICE EXPENSES – GROUP SERVICES

#### INCOME

|               |           |
|---------------|-----------|
| Contributions | \$538,000 |
|---------------|-----------|

#### TOTAL EXPENSES

|                            |           |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| Excess of Income (Expense) | ( 44,200) |
|----------------------------|-----------|

\*\*Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$40,800

### GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

#### INCOME

\$ -0-

#### TOTAL EXPENSE

|  |        |
|--|--------|
|  | 68,500 |
|--|--------|

|                            |           |
|----------------------------|-----------|
| Excess of Income (Expense) | ( 68,500) |
|----------------------------|-----------|

\*\*\*Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, P.R.C. Expense Special Projects, and World Service Meeting.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$112,700 to the budgeted deficits.

# 1972 Grapevine Budget

|                                                         |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Estimated income from subscription and other sales..... | \$286,000 |
| Estimated Expense.....                                  | 277,400   |
| Net income from operations.....                         | 8,600     |
| Interest from investments.....                          | 9,500     |
| Net Income.....                                         | 18,100    |

## 1971 Group Contributions

| U.S.                   | # Gps.<br>re-<br>ported | # Gps.<br>Contrib. | %<br>of Gps.<br>Contrib. | # Gps.<br>on R.C.P. | %<br>of Gps.<br>on R.C.P. | Amount of<br>Contrib. | Member-<br>ship | Contrib's.<br>per<br>Capita | CANADA                    | # Gps.<br>re-<br>ported | # Gps.<br>Contrib. | %<br>of Gps.<br>Contrib. | # Gps.<br>on R.C.P. | %<br>of Gps.<br>on R.C.P. | Amount of<br>Contrib. | Member-<br>ship | Contrib's.<br>per<br>Capita |
|------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|
| Alabama                | 91                      | 47                 | 51.6%                    | 13                  | 27.7%                     | \$ 2,883.16           | 1,543           | \$ 1.87                     | Alberta                   | 160                     | 86                 | 53.8%                    | 3                   | 3.5%                      | \$ 3,788.50           | 1,644           | \$ 2.30                     |
| Alaska                 | 42                      | 19                 | 45.2                     | 8                   | 42.1                      | 1,518.00              | 465             | 3.26                        | Atlantic Prov.            |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Arizona                | 144                     | 71                 | 49.3                     | 19                  | 26.7                      | 6,088.45              | 1,850           | 3.29                        | New Brunswick             | 57                      | 36                 | 63.2                     | 4                   | 11.1                      | 1,241.47              | 760             | 1.63                        |
| Arkansas               | 78                      | 49                 | 62.8                     | 16                  | 32.7                      | 2,821.00              | 1,026           | 2.75                        | Newfoundland              | 16                      | 9                  | 56.3                     | 2                   | 22.2                      | 371.50                | 186             | 2.00                        |
| California             | 1,469                   | 899                | 61.2                     | 372                 | 41.4                      | 59,180.79             | 34,564          | 1.71                        | Nova Scotia               | 67                      | 47                 | 70.1                     | 7                   | 14.9                      | 1,983.52              | 761             | 2.61                        |
| Colorado               | 150                     | 101                | 67.3                     | 45                  | 44.5                      | 5,825.26              | 2,260           | 2.58                        | Prince Ed. Is.            | 22                      | 14                 | 63.6                     | 2                   | 14.3                      | 575.00                | 359             | 1.60                        |
| Connecticut            | 258                     | 155                | 60.1                     | 46                  | 29.7                      | 10,846.40             | 4,114           | 2.64                        | British Columbia          | 224                     | 134                | 59.8                     | 21                  | 15.7                      | 7,739.53              | 2,808           | 2.76                        |
| Delaware               | 36                      | 31                 | 86.1                     | 12                  | 38.7                      | 1,791.00              | 541             | 3.31                        | Manitoba                  | 92                      | 46                 | 50.0                     | 4                   | 8.7                       | 2,772.58              | 1,745           | 1.59                        |
| Dist. of Columbia      | 61                      | 33                 | 54.1                     | 20                  | 60.6                      | 4,650.89              | 1,778           | 2.62                        | N.W. Territories          | 5                       | 3                  | 60.0                     | -0-                 | -0-                       | 93.82                 | 28              | 4.30                        |
| Florida                | 367                     | 236                | 64.3                     | 111                 | 47.0                      | 23,911.59             | 5,873           | 4.07                        | Ontario                   | 511                     | 328                | 64.2                     | 88                  | 26.8                      | 24,216.89             | 7,351           | 3.29                        |
| Georgia                | 185                     | 132                | 71.4                     | 53                  | 40.2                      | 6,134.44              | 2,582           | 2.38                        | Quebec                    | 513                     | 275                | 53.6                     | 98                  | 35.6                      | 10,774.67             | 11,793          | .91                         |
| Hawaii                 | 42                      | 27                 | 64.3                     | 6                   | 22.2                      | 1,104.85              | 553             | 2.00                        | Saskatchewan              | 146                     | 81                 | 55.5                     | 3                   | 3.7                       | 3,536.61              | 1,615           | 2.19                        |
| Idaho                  | 46                      | 28                 | 60.9                     | 7                   | 25.0                      | 940.80                | 482             | 1.95                        | Yukon Terr.               | 2                       | 2                  | 100.0                    | -0-                 | -0-                       | 64.40                 | 23              | 2.80                        |
| Illinois               | 737                     | 472                | 64.0                     | 89                  | 18.9                      | 16,538.10             | 15,781          | 1.05                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Indiana                | 217                     | 149                | 68.7                     | 48                  | 32.2                      | 9,519.60              | 2,937           | 3.24                        | TOTAL for CANADA          | 1,815                   | 1,061              | 58.5%                    | 232                 | 21.8%                     | \$ 57,158.49          | 29,073          | \$ 1.97                     |
| Iowa                   | 139                     | 92                 | 66.2                     | 21                  | 22.8                      | 5,499.98              | 2,524           | 2.18                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Kansas                 | 128                     | 84                 | 65.6                     | 19                  | 22.6                      | 4,696.08              | 2,293           | 2.05                        | TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA | 12,160                  | 7,795              | 64.1%                    | 2,529               | 32.4%                     | \$493,592.92          | 210,522         | \$ 2.34                     |
| Kentucky               | 136                     | 93                 | 68.4                     | 18                  | 19.3                      | 7,591.20              | 1,590           | 4.77-2                      |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Louisiana              | 118                     | 78                 | 66.1                     | 15                  | 19.2                      | 3,602.53              | 2,052           | 1.76                        | FOREIGN & OTHER           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Maine                  | 55                      | 39                 | 70.9                     | 9                   | 23.1                      | 1,910.00              | 632             | 3.02                        | Foreign                   |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 2,653.05              |                 |                             |
| Maryland               | 192                     | 143                | 74.5                     | 38                  | 26.5                      | 8,415.25              | 2,753           | 3.06                        | World Hello               |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 34.45                 |                 |                             |
| Massachusetts          | 352                     | 200                | 56.8                     | 67                  | 33.5                      | 14,003.75             | 6,954           | 2.01                        | International Doctors     |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 200.00                |                 |                             |
| Michigan               | 406                     | 272                | 67.0                     | 89                  | 32.7                      | 22,941.13             | 6,608           | 3.47                        | Hospital Groups           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 1,693.60              |                 |                             |
| Minnesota              | 302                     | 190                | 56.3                     | 32                  | 16.8                      | 10,107.65             | 6,761           | 1.49                        | Prison Groups             |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 107.00                |                 |                             |
| Mississippi            | 60                      | 35                 | 58.3                     | 13                  | 37.1                      | 1,705.50              | 854             | 2.00                        | Internationalists         |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 1,103.55              |                 |                             |
| Missouri               | 219                     | 135                | 61.6                     | 41                  | 30.4                      | 7,337.98              | 3,381           | 2.17                        | Young People in A.A.      |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 300.00                |                 |                             |
| Montana                | 63                      | 38                 | 60.3                     | 8                   | 21.1                      | 1,238.55              | 643             | 1.93                        | Amateur Radio             |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | 10.00                 |                 |                             |
| Nebraska               | 93                      | 61                 | 65.6                     | 14                  | 23.0                      | 3,713.26              | 1,118           | 3.32                        | GRAND TOTAL               |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           | \$499,694.57          |                 |                             |
| Nevada                 | 53                      | 41                 | 77.4                     | 15                  | 36.6                      | 1,960.77              | 1,024           | 1.91                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| New Hampshire          | 52                      | 32                 | 61.5                     | 13                  | 40.6                      | 1,910.33              | 789             | 2.42                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| New Jersey             | 328                     | 237                | 72.3                     | 99                  | 41.8                      | 17,416.00             | 5,119           | 3.40                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| New Mexico             | 76                      | 43                 | 56.6                     | 17                  | 39.5                      | 1,973.58              | 1,148           | 1.72                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| New York               | 673                     | 470                | 69.8                     | 248                 | 52.8                      | 38,062.53             | 11,954          | 3.18                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| North Carolina         | 189                     | 142                | 75.1                     | 48                  | 33.8                      | 8,347.83              | 2,703           | 3.09                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| North Dakota           | 57                      | 34                 | 59.6                     | 9                   | 26.5                      | 1,694.95              | 627             | 2.70                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Ohio                   | 532                     | 300                | 56.4                     | 77                  | 25.7                      | 18,518.69             | 9,937           | 1.86                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Oklahoma               | 117                     | 93                 | 79.5                     | 57                  | 61.3                      | 6,359.40              | 1,522           | 4.18-4                      |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Oregon                 | 118                     | 75                 | 63.6                     | 23                  | 30.7                      | 3,407.55              | 1,246           | 2.73                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Pennsylvania           | 373                     | 266                | 71.3                     | 118                 | 44.4                      | 21,883.66             | 6,172           | 2.09                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Rhode Island           | 42                      | 32                 | 76.2                     | 16                  | 50.0                      | 2,264.10              | 499             | 4.54-3                      |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| South Carolina         | 73                      | 49                 | 67.1                     | 17                  | 34.7                      | 3,154.31              | 1,159           | 2.72                        | U.S.A. 1971               | 10,345                  | 6,734              | 65.1%                    | 2,297               | 34.1%                     | \$436,434.43          | 181,499         | \$ 2.41                     |
| South Dakota           | 48                      | 31                 | 64.6                     | 4                   | 12.9                      | 1,602.90              | 896             | 1.79                        | U.S.A. 1970               | 9,541                   | 6,129              | 64.2                     | 1,843               | 30.1                      | 380,995.95            | 167,167         | 2.28                        |
| Tennessee              | 104                     | 70                 | 67.3                     | 15                  | 21.4                      | 3,156.50              | 1,652           | 1.91                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Texas                  | 401                     | 278                | 69.3                     | 91                  | 32.7                      | 18,843.95             | 8,016           | 2.35                        | Increase                  |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Utah                   | 58                      | 43                 | 74.1                     | 10                  | 23.3                      | 2,070.98              | 692             | 3.00                        | (Decrease)                | 804                     | 605                | 0.9%                     | 454                 | 4.0%                      | \$ 55,438.48          | 14,282          | \$ .13                      |
| Vermont                | 33                      | 26                 | 78.8                     | 9                   | 34.6                      | 2,495.16              | 391             | 6.38-1                      |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Virginia               | 177                     | 136                | 76.8                     | 53                  | 39.0                      | 9,057.92              | 3,115           | 2.91                        | Canada 1971               | 1,815                   | 1,061              | 58.5%                    | 232                 | 21.8%                     | \$ 57,158.49          | 29,073          | \$ 1.97                     |
| Washington             | 247                     | 155                | 62.8                     | 56                  | 36.1                      | 12,077.00             | 3,053           | 3.96                        | Canada 1970               | 1,667                   | 958                | 57.5                     | 209                 | 21.8                      | 47,434.08             | 25,957          | 1.83                        |
| West Virginia          | 70                      | 47                 | 67.1                     | 17                  | 36.2                      | 2,739.00              | 839             | 3.26                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Wisconsin              | 261                     | 173                | 66.3                     | 24                  | 13.9                      | 8,188.13              | 3,295           | 2.49                        | Increase                  |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Wyoming                | 29                      | 17                 | 58.6                     | 2                   | 11.8                      | 662.00                | 316             | 2.09                        | (Decrease)                | 148                     | 103                | 1.0%                     | 23                  | 0.0%                      | \$ 9,723.41           | 3,116           | \$ .14                      |
| Commonwealth of P.R.   | 38                      | 27                 | 71.1                     | 4                   | 14.8                      | 1,360.00              | 624             | 2.18                        | U.S. & Canada 1971        | 12,160                  | 7,795              | 64.1%                    | 2,529               | 32.4%                     | \$493,592.92          | 210,552         | \$ 2.35                     |
| Canal Zone             | 2                       | 2                  | 100.0                    | 2                   | 100.0                     | 535.00                | 59              | 9.07                        | U.S. & Canada 1970        | 11,208                  | 7,087              | 63.2                     | 2,052               | 28.9                      | 428,430.43            | 193,124         | 2.22                        |
| Bahama Islands         | 5                       | 4                  | 80.0                     | 2                   | 50.0                      | 110.00                | 60              | 1.72                        |                           |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Virgin Islands of U.S. | 3                       | 2                  | 66.6                     | 2                   | 100.0                     | 65.00                 | 30              | 2.17                        | Increase                  |                         |                    |                          |                     |                           |                       |                 |                             |
| Total for U.S.         | 10,345                  | 6,734              | 65.1%                    | 2,297               | 34.1                      | \$436,434.43          | 181,449         | \$ 2.41                     | (Decrease)                | 952                     | 708                | 0.9%                     | 477                 | 3.5%                      | \$ 65,162.49          | 17,428          | \$ .13                      |

# INCOME STATEMENT

## The General Service Office

### YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1971

|                                                                                 | <u>1971</u>     | <u>1970</u>                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>INCOME</b>                                                                   |                 |                                |
| Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$51,775 in 1971 and \$40,949 in 1970 | \$672,099       | \$524,775                      |
| Less: Cost of Printing                                                          | 204,126         | 157,138                        |
| Royalties                                                                       | <u>74,098</u>   | <u>58,307</u>                  |
| Gross Profit from Literature                                                    | 393,875         | 309,330                        |
| Contributions - A.A. Groups and Members                                         | 498,849         | 434,633                        |
| 35th Anniversary Convention                                                     | <u>-</u>        | <u>15,809</u>                  |
| Total Income                                                                    | <u>892,724</u>  | <u>759,772</u>                 |
| <b>EXPENSES</b>                                                                 |                 |                                |
| Salaries                                                                        | \$448,690       | \$404,520                      |
| Rent                                                                            | 49,704          | 49,966                         |
| Office relocation costs                                                         | 1,950           | 134,626                        |
| Bulletin: Box 4-5-9                                                             | 19,401          | 17,656                         |
| World Directory                                                                 | 28,787          | 25,455                         |
| Other Service Office Printing                                                   | 14,338          | 14,455                         |
| Shipping and Mailing                                                            | 80,850          | 61,525                         |
| Other Office Expenses                                                           | 72,774          | 74,835                         |
| Insurance and Taxes                                                             | 37,969          | 30,335                         |
| Professional Services                                                           | 14,375          | 11,800                         |
| Board, Committee, Staff Meetings                                                | 19,699          | 13,302                         |
| Writing, Research, Bedford Hills                                                | 2,346           | 8,886                          |
| P.I.C., P.R.C., Travel                                                          | 17,421          | 7,847                          |
| General Service Conference                                                      | 34,656          | 33,766                         |
| Communications - Bill's death                                                   | 11,117          | -                              |
| Foreign Literature Aid                                                          | 1,618           | 1,643                          |
| Film, Film Strip, Display Boards                                                | <u>3,157</u>    | <u>1,403</u>                   |
| Total Expense                                                                   | <u>858,852</u>  | <u>892,020</u>                 |
| NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)                                          | <u>33,872</u>   | <u>( 132,248)</u>              |
| <b>NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION</b>                                         |                 |                                |
| World Service Office - Group Fund                                               | \$ (23,371)     | \$ (56,889)                    |
| Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc.                                          | 115,174         | 74,134                         |
| General Fund - General Service Board                                            | <u>(57,931)</u> | <u>(149,493)</u>               |
| <b>CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS - 1971</b>                                            |                 |                                |
|                                                                                 | <u>Pension</u>  | <u>Reserve</u> <u>Memorial</u> |
| Balance, January 1, 1971                                                        | \$ 21,083       | \$254,104                      |
| Book Discounts                                                                  | 51,775          |                                |
| Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.                                            | 3,500           |                                |
| Investment Income                                                               | 732             | 17,489                         |
| Contributions Received                                                          |                 | \$ 1,208                       |
| Less: Current Funding Costs                                                     | (50,486)        | 35,774                         |
| Additional Funding of Past Service Cost                                         | (20,000)        |                                |
| Actuary Fee                                                                     | <u>( 3,429)</u> |                                |
| Balance, December 31, 1971                                                      | <u>3,175</u>    | <u>271,593</u> <u>36,982</u>   |
| ( ) Denotes red figures                                                         |                 |                                |

Amounts in these financial statements under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 - by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts - for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

# INCOME STATEMENT

## The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

### YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1971

|                                             | 1971                    | 1970                    |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| INCOME - FROM SUBSCRIPTIONS AND OTHER SALES | <u>\$263,463.62</u>     | <u>\$243,356.54</u>     |
| EDITORIAL AND PRINTING                      |                         |                         |
| Salaries                                    | \$ 39,745.74            | \$ 35,572.73            |
| Printing                                    | 60,826.63               | 52,278.53               |
| Mailing - Service                           | 28,540.54               | 29,479.02               |
| Postage                                     | 5,060.88                | -                       |
| Other printing costs                        | 3,057.17                | 1,459.19                |
| Calendar costs                              | 8,913.28                | 6,757.58                |
| Best Cartoons                               | 1,706.60                | 2,752.61                |
| Rent                                        | 6,656.16                | 6,925.37                |
| Telephone                                   | 1,223.32                | 1,182.88                |
| Office supplies and expense                 | 1,893.85                | 2,526.60                |
| Other editorial expenses                    | 3,058.26                | 2,971.19                |
| Office cleaning                             | <u>1,031.52</u>         | <u>869.03</u>           |
| Total                                       | <u>161,713.95</u>       | <u>142,774.73</u>       |
| CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS                    |                         |                         |
| Salaries                                    | \$ 47,950.77            | \$ 43,759.36            |
| Stationery and supplies                     | 3,490.02                | 2,449.01                |
| Rent                                        | 6,656.13                | 6,925.32                |
| Telephone                                   | 1,215.72                | 1,102.43                |
| Other office expense                        | 426.87                  | 1,188.05                |
| Selling expense                             | 10,098.50               | 7,785.34                |
| Postage                                     | 6,466.10                | 5,166.11                |
| Office cleaning                             | 1,031.50                | 869.00                  |
| Bad debts                                   | <u>891.60</u>           | <u>773.10</u>           |
| Total                                       | <u>78,227.21</u>        | <u>70,017.72</u>        |
| GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE                  |                         |                         |
| Insurance                                   | \$ 3,275.46             | \$ 3,596.44             |
| Legal and accounting                        | 4,100.00                | 3,600.00                |
| Taxes                                       | 4,675.79                | 3,822.96                |
| Meetings and conferences                    | 660.00                  | 1,353.78                |
| Moving expenses                             | -                       | 1,987.20                |
| Office construction costs                   | -                       | 5,217.00                |
| Furniture and equipment                     | 339.50                  | 2,201.00                |
| Contribution to Retirement Plan             | <u>3,500.00</u>         | <u>3,500.00</u>         |
| Total                                       | <u>16,550.75</u>        | <u>25,278.38</u>        |
| TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES                    | <u>256,491.91</u>       | <u>238,070.83</u>       |
| INCOME FROM OPERATIONS                      | 6,971.71                | 5,285.71                |
| Add: Interest on savings accounts           | <u>8,818.68</u>         | <u>8,709.77</u>         |
| NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)             | <u><u>15,790.39</u></u> | <u><u>13,995.48</u></u> |

(continued from p. 36)

The MEMORIAL FUND, which was established in 1971 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members in memory of Bill W. The funds have been deposited in separate savings accounts until such time as the General Service Conference authorizes their expenditure for a suitable memorial or purpose.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In these statements, the net worth and net operating results of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

# COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

## The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1971

|                                                     | December 31, 1971 |                | December 31, 1970 |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------|-------------------|----------------|
| OPERATING FUNDS                                     | Service Office    | A.A. Grapevine | Service Office    | A.A. Grapevine |
| <b>ASSETS</b>                                       |                   |                |                   |                |
| Cash                                                | \$191,504         | \$ 52,242      | \$105,285         | \$ 33,674      |
| Savings Accounts and Certificates                   |                   | 16,416         |                   | 17,790         |
| Marketable Securities                               |                   | 100,419        |                   | 90,447         |
| Accounts Receivable                                 | 18,375            | 9,210          | 18,504            | 6,160          |
| Quebec General Service Committee                    | 7,864             |                |                   |                |
| Due from Grapevine and Reserve Fund                 | 12,000            |                | 39,724            |                |
| Inventories                                         | 130,200           | 8,317          | 124,500           | 8,602          |
| Prepaid Expenses                                    | 17,913            | 5,390          | 26,754            | 4,314          |
| <u>Total Assets</u>                                 | <u>377,856</u>    | <u>191,994</u> | <u>314,767</u>    | <u>160,987</u> |
| <b>DEDUCT LIABILITIES</b>                           |                   |                |                   |                |
| Accounts and accruals payable                       | 36,696            | 19,768         | 20,288            | 14,729         |
| Due Pension Fund                                    | 3,907             |                | 3,098             |                |
| Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income              |                   | 119,860        |                   | 97,683         |
| Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments                |                   | 7,000          |                   | 7,000          |
| <u>Total Liabilities</u>                            | <u>40,603</u>     | <u>146,628</u> | <u>23,386</u>     | <u>119,412</u> |
| <b>NET WORTH</b>                                    |                   |                |                   |                |
| Balance, January 1                                  | 291,381           | 41,575         | 304,401           | 65,579         |
| Net Income (loss) for Year (Exhibits A and B)       | 33,872            | 15,791         | (132,248)         | 13,996         |
| Dividend (paid) or received                         | 12,000            | ( 12,000)      | 38,000            | ( 38,000)      |
| Transfers from Reserve and Convention Funds         |                   |                | 66,500            |                |
| Transfer from Reserve for EDP Installation          |                   |                | 14,728            |                |
| <u>Total Net Worth</u>                              | <u>337,253</u>    | <u>45,366</u>  | <u>291,381</u>    | <u>41,575</u>  |
| <b>NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND</b>                |                   |                |                   |                |
| World Service Office – Group Fund (Note B)          | \$ 11,252         |                | \$ 11,123         |                |
| Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)     | 238,658           |                | 223,484           |                |
| General Fund – G.S.B. (Notes A and B)               | 87,343            |                | 56,774            |                |
| <u>Total Operating Funds – as above</u>             | <u>337,253</u>    |                | <u>291,381</u>    |                |
| Reserve Fund                                        | 271,593           |                | 254,104           |                |
| Deferred Pension Fund                               | 3,175             |                | 21,083            |                |
| Memorial Fund                                       | 36,982            |                | –                 |                |
| <u>Total Net Worth</u>                              | <u>649,003</u>    |                | <u>566,568</u>    |                |
| <b>RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION AND MEMORIAL FUNDS</b> | <u>Reserve</u>    | <u>Pension</u> | <u>Memorial</u>   |                |
| Cash                                                | \$ 559            |                |                   |                |
| Savings Accounts and Certificates                   | 7,269             | \$ 11,889      | \$ 35,826         |                |
| Due from A.A.W.S. and General Fund                  |                   | 3,907          | 5                 |                |
| U.S. Treasury obligations                           | 170,112           |                |                   |                |
| Government Agency and Corporate Bonds               | 89,320            |                |                   |                |
| Accrued Interest                                    | 4,333             |                | 1,151             |                |
| Less: Due Retirement Trust                          |                   | (12,621)       |                   |                |
| <u>BALANCE, DECEMBER 31</u>                         | <u>271,593</u>    | <u>3,175</u>   | <u>36,982</u>     |                |

( ) Denotes red figures

NOTE A – After transfers of \$100,000 in 1971, and \$50,000 in 1970 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B – Transfers of \$23,500 in 1971 and \$56,900 in 1970 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in group contributions in those years.

These financial statements and notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

# 1972 Conference Members\*\*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

## NONALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

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Vincent Dole, M.D.  
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Austin H. MacCormick (1st Vice Chm.)  
Osborne Association, Inc.  
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New York, New York 10016

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.  
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Piscataway, N. J. 08854

Arthur Miles (Treasurer)  
212 Poplar Street  
Floral Park, N. Y. 11001

## ALCOHOLIC TRUSTEES

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Glen Head, New York 11545

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Chappell Hill Farm  
Chappell Hill, Texas 77426

\* William Coogan  
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\* Donald Farrell (2nd Vice Chairman)  
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Robert G. Pearson (until July 1972)  
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Niles Peebles  
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† John Rae (Secretary)  
Heatherview Manor, Apt. 7  
Swift Current, Sask., Canada

Robert Roy  
75 Marengere Street - Apt. 6  
Hull, Quebec, Canada

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Jack Morley (Editor)  
Paula Carpenter (Vice President, Secretary)  
George Gordon (Treasurer)  
Austin MacCormick  
Charles Edgar  
Robert Pearson  
Thomas Carpenter  
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Robert Pearson (1st Vice Chairman)  
Midge McFadden (2nd Vice Chairman)  
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Walter Murphy  
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Ann Macfarlane (Secretary)

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Paula Carpenter  
Jack Morley

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Cora Louise Belford  
Beth Kuhlmann  
Betty Liddle  
Phyllis MacDonald  
Ann Macfarlane  
Midge McFadden  
Waneta New  
Valerie Seyffert  
Mary Ellen Uribe

\*term completed 4/72  
(see p. 41 for new trustees elected April 1972)  
†Jim Hiers died April 27, 1972 and John Rae died May 9, 1972

Al Cryan, Manager, Shipping  
Barbara Netterwald, Manager, Records  
Kleina Jones, Office Manager  
Ann Couig, Manager, Clerical/Steno  
Nell Wing, Production Editor, Box 4-5-9

Dennis Manders, Controller  
Charles Columbia, Manager, Accounting and  
Ass't. Controller  
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.  
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A.

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee  
Two Observers from: Literature Committee  
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board  
Two Observers from: Professional Relations

\*\*Members of Conference other than area delegates

# Trustees of the General Service Board

## Nonalcoholic Trustees

**JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D.** . . . is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was the associate medical director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, N.Y. He is chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and a former president of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics. He lives in New London, N.H.

**JOHN D. BEALER, M.D.** . . . elected to the Board in April, 1971; is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corporation, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society of Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the Trustees' Policy and Finance Committees.

**TRAVIS E. DANCEY, M.D.** . . . elected to the Board in January, 1965. Before his partial retirement, Dr. Dancey was chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital. Now he is senior psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital and associate professor at McGill University. He has been a good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec. He is the first nonalcoholic trustee to serve from Canada. Dr. Dancey serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committee.

**VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D.** . . . elected to the Board in April, 1965. He is professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller University Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in treatment of narcotic addiction; he

is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the Trustees' Policy Committee.

**AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK** . . . is 1st vice chairman of the General Service Board—was elected to the Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a director of the A.A. Grapevine, a member of its corporate and editorial boards, serves as chairman of the Trustees' Literature Committee and is a member of the Nominating Committee.

**MILTON A. MAXWELL, Ph.D.** . . . elected to the Board in April, 1971; he is executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies and professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics and Alcoholics Anonymous. His most recent research has focused on the relations between professionals and Alcoholics Anonymous. He serves on the Trustees' Long-Range Planning, Professional Relations and Policy Committees.

**ARTHUR J. MILES** . . . was elected to the Board in April, 1970. He is a senior vice president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and on the Board of Trustees of the American Institute of Banking and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He resides in Floral Park, L.I. with his wife and two children; serves as chairman of the Trustees' Finance and Retirement Committees.

## A.A. Trustees

**RALPH W. AHRINGER** . . . elected to the Board in April 1971, and elected chairman and president of the Grapevine Corporate Board in April, 1972. He is a member of the Trustees Nominating and Literature Committees. Ralph had his last drink in 1954. He is a former delegate (Panel 13) to the General Service Conference and former chairman and treasurer of the S.E. New York General Service Committee, as well as former president of New York Intergroup. Most recently he was chairman of the Intergroup Advisory Committee. He is sales manager and advertising manager of Sabin Robbins Paper Company.

**DONALD G. AUSTIN** . . . elected to the Board from the Southwest region in April, 1971. Don had his last drink in 1953. He is a former chairman of the Texas State A.A. Convention and committee member from the Southwest Texas area. Also vice chairman of the Texas Commission on Alcoholism, and a member of the Board of the Houston Council on Alcoholism. Don serves on the Trustees' Professional Relations, Policy and Finance Committees.

\***WILLIAM COOGAN** . . . was elected to the Board in April, 1969, as trustee from the Northeast region. Since his last drink in 1958, he has served in many capacities from group treasurer to area delegate (Panel 15). Bill practices law in Boston, Mass. He is a member of the Harvard Alumni and the Boston College Alumni Associations. He is also a member of the American Bar Association and the Massachusetts Trial Lawyers Association. He serves on the Trustees' Nominating Committee and is chairman of the Policy Committee.

\***DONALD F. FARRELL** . . . was elected to the Board in April, 1968, as trustee from the West Central region. He had his last drink in 1943. After helping start A.A. in Des Moines, he became one of the original members in Omaha. A former delegate (Panel 6), he is active in institutions work and court programs for alcoholics. Don owns and operates a photographic business. He is a member of the Trustees' Policy Committee and is co-chairman of the Nominating Committee.

**THOMAS D. GRAFTON** . . . elected to the Board as general service trustee, Canada, in April, 1971. He had his last drink in 1960 and is active in institutions, intergroup and general service work. Tom is a former delegate (Panel 18) from Manitoba and former chairman of the Manitoba General Service Committee. A member of the legal firm of Grafton and Company, Tom is also a member of the Canadian Bar Association and the Manitoba Bar Association. He serves on the Trustees' Policy and Finance Committees.

**GEORGE GRIMSTAD** . . . elected to the Board from the Pacific region in April, 1971. He is a former delegate (Panel 11) from Chicago, Illinois, now living in Arizona, and was one of the founders of the General Service Committee and Intergroup in Chicago. George had his last drink in 1950. He is Outreach Worker for St. Luke Hospital's Alcohol and Drug Abuse Program in Phoenix and serves as liaison with courts, law enforcement officials, jails, hospitals and rehab centers. He is a director



for Northern Arizona Recovery Centers. George serves on the Trustees' Policy and Literature Committees.

## NEW TRUSTEES

†**JAMES E. HIERS**... was elected to the Board as general service trustee, U.S., in April, 1970. He had his last drink in 1951 and was a Panel 7 delegate to the General Service Conference. Active in numerous charitable and civic associations, Jim is the administrative management officer for NASA in Huntsville, Alabama, and serves on the Trustees' Finance, Policy and Professional Relations Committees.

**JACK R. MEAGHER**... elected to the Board from the East Central region in April, 1971. He had his last drink in 1949. A former delegate (Panel 6) from Western Michigan, Jack also served as chairman of the State Conference and Western Michigan General Service Committee. He is director of the Computer Center and is associate professor of mathematics at Western Michigan University. Jack serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

**THOMAS W. MOORE**... elected to the Board in April, 1971, from the Southeast region. He had his last drink in 1950. He is a former delegate (Panel 18) from Tennessee as well as chairman of the state committee. A lawyer, Tom is senior partner of Moore, Henry, Henry, Lewis & Cain and immediate past president of the Pulaski-Giles County Bar Association. He also serves as trustee for a college and a charitable institution. Tom currently serves on the Trustees' Nominating Committee and is co-chairman of the Policy Committee.

**STEPHEN C. OWEN, Sr.**... was elected to the Board in April, 1969, and began serving the end of July. He has held various positions in his home group in Long Island. He had his last drink in 1960, and served as N.Y. Intergroup treasurer in 1962 and 1963. Steve retired in 1968 from the Beacon Manufacturing Company, a textile firm, and is currently president of Servico Company, a sizable investment company, and director of other companies as well. Steve is treasurer of A.A.W.S., Inc. and is a member of the Trustees' Policy and Finance Committees, chairman of the Professional Relations Committee and co-chairman of the Literature Committee.

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\*\***ROBERT PEARSON**... was elected to the Board in July, 1968. He had his last drink in 1961. He is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board as well as of A.A.W.S., Inc. He was chairman of the Public Information Committee of New York Intergroup and is a former president of the Fairfield County (Conn.) Council on Alcoholism. He is an executive with The Council of Better Business Bureau, Inc. Bob is chairman of the Trustees' Nominating Committee and also serves on the Policy and Long-Range Planning Committees.

**NILES N. PEEBLES**... elected as a service trustee in January, 1972. He had his last drink in 1957. He is presently a director of A.A.W.S., Inc. and a member of the Policy and World Service Meeting Planning Committees. He has also served as chairman of the Trustees' International Committee and on the Public Information and Nominating Committees. Niles was also first vice president of the Intergroup Association of New York. He is a former newspaperman and is currently a free-lance writer.

†**JOHN RAE**... was elected to the Board April, 1969, from the Western Canada region. He had his last drink in 1955 and has been active in group area affairs. He served his area as delegate 1960-1961. John is the manager of the Medical Clinic in Swift Current, Saskatchewan, Canada. He serves on the Trustees' Professional Relations, Policy and Literature Committees.

**ROBERT ROY**... elected to the Board in April, 1971, from the Eastern Canada region, he had his last drink in April, 1959. A former delegate (Panel 14) from Quebec, Bob is a co-founder of "La Vigne," a French-language publication for A.A. members and was chairman of the Quebec General Service Committee, as well as secretary of Montreal Intergroup. He is an auditor with the office of Audit Services Bureau, Government of Canada. Bob serves on the Trustees' Policy, Nominating and Literature Committees.

\*Retiring as of April, 1972

\*\*Retires July, 1972

†Jim died April 27, 1972; John died May 9, 1972

**JUNIOR ANDERSON**... elected as regional trustee from the Northeast region. He has been sober 14 years and active in group and area A.A. activities since 1958, including two years' service as Eastern Massachusetts' delegate (Panel 19) to the General Service Conference. He continues to be active as a speaker at meetings both inside and outside A.A., was chairman of the State Convention, 1969-70 and chairman of the First Northeast Region Convention, 1971. Junior is Sales Representative in the Boston District Office of the Otis Elevator Co., for whom he has worked for the past 19 years. He is married, with four daughters and lives in Needham, Massachusetts.

**JAMES GRIFFIN**... elected as regional trustee from the West Central region. He has been sober 20 years, has served as G.S.R., committee member, chairman of the state committee and served as delegate (Panel 18). Jim attends A.A. functions in Nebraska and surrounding states, is active in local groups and has helped to start a number of them. He owns and pilots his own plane and has had a successful career for 16 years in the insurance business. He is married and lives in North Platte, Nebraska.

**MATT NEWELL**... elected as regional trustee from Western Canada. He has been sober 22 years; in 1950, started the first group in Chadron, Nebraska. He has been past provincial secretary for Alberta and in 1952 organized Beginners Meetings in Calgary. Outside of A.A., Matt is director of the Alcoholism Foundation of Alberta, a member of the Advisory Board of the Department of Health of Alberta and a current member of the Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission of Alberta. He is president of the Spruce Oils, Ltd., is married and lives in Calgary.

**GEORGE N. GORDON**... was elected as a service trustee in April, 1972, to start serving after the July Board Meeting. He is a director of the A.A. Grapevine Inc. and has served as treasurer since 1970. Since his last drink in 1964, he has served his local group in most offices as well as serving on several committees of the New York Intergroup Association. George holds a Ph.D. from New York University. He is presently director of the Communications Center at Hofstra University in Hempstead, N.Y. He is the author or co-author of numerous works, including twelve non-fiction books, ten of them written after joining our Fellowship. George presently serves as a member of the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees and as treasurer of the Grapevine, Inc.

## DR. JACK'S TRIP (from p. 33)

drugs," saying that the same situation was true in Viet Nam, though the drug problem there was greater than in Germany. He was told that "men in trouble with alcohol seldom reach out for help until they have been in serious difficulty for a considerable time, usually after 15-17 years in service. . . Those near retirement usually prefer to leave the service rather than undergo rehabilitation."

Noting the absence of physicians at the meetings, Dr. Norris recommended that a team of physicians in the U.S., knowledgeable about alcoholism and A.A., conduct a training program for physicians serving overseas, enabling them to be of greater service to alcoholics. He believes that an active educational program to combat alcohol addiction in the armed services is essential. He suggested that a comic-book-type pamphlet describing the disease concept might be useful for service men.

Dr. Norris also held meetings with the chaplains in the U.S. Air Force base at Mildenhall, England.

## DELEGATES' OPPORTUNITY TO QUESTION THE BOARD

To the question, "What Are the Functions and Qualifications of the Trustees," the following answer was given by Dr. Norris:

As stated in the A.A. Service Manual, the primary purpose of the Board of Trustees is custodial—to maintain services for the Fellowship of A.A. The General Service Conference is referred to whenever a decision on movement-wide policy is needed. However, trustees do participate in policy-making as individual members of the Conference.

There are 21 trustees on the Board. Of these, seven, are Class A, or nonalcoholic trustees, while 14 are Class B, or alcoholic.

The Class A trustees, including the chairman of the Board, may be chosen for their concern and feeling for alcoholics and the A.A. Fellowship, as well as for their professional qualifications in such fields as medicine, law, finance, communication and education. In addition to providing professional expertise and guidance in matters affecting A.A. as a whole, and/or the Grapevine, the nonalcoholic trustee may be asked to speak or represent A.A., in public, should the occasion arise.

There are 6 general service and 8 regional Class B trustees. Four of the general service trustees are from the New York commuting area. These 'in town' trustees are elected to provide special business and professional skills which may be needed in the day to day operations of A.A.W.S., G.S.O. and the Grapevine. These trustees, in addition to their expertise in some specific area, must be—and they are—available on a daily basis.

The general service trustees from Canada and the U.S. are also elected on the basis of their background and experience as specified by the Board. They take on special assignments and attend selected professional meetings throughout the United States and Canada. And, naturally, they share in the responsibilities that *all* trustees share—those that involve the welfare of the Fellowship as a whole.

While the regional trustees also usually bring a special skill or expertise to the Board, they are selected primarily for their leadership qualities, their quality of sobriety, participation in A.A. affairs, grasp of A.A. structure, and knowledge of A.A. problems and thinking in their areas. They, too, serve on various committees and like all other trustees, are available for special assignments. They speak at state and area get-togethers and provide a vital channel of communication between the Board and the grass roots membership.

### PANEL 22 DELEGATES NOTE:

You are reminded to keep handy the current summaries of the Ask-it Baskets and Advisory Actions, which were mailed before the 1972 Conference. *Only* supplements from the 1972 Conference will be mailed to you by March 10, 1973. Please place these supplements under the proper categories in your present copies and *bring them with you to the 1973 Conference.*

## 1972 TRUSTEES' COMMITTEES

### FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Arthur J. Miles, Chairman  
Donald G. Austin  
John D. Bealer, M.D.  
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.  
George Gordon  
Tom D. Grafton  
Jim Hiers  
Robert E. Hitchins  
Jack R. Meagher  
Stephen Owen, Sr.  
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)  
Dennis Manders, secretary

### Retirement Committee

Arthur J. Miles, Chairman  
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.  
George Gordon  
Jack R. Meagher  
Stephen Owen, Sr.  
Robert E. Hitchins, secretary

### LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman  
Stephen Owen, Sr., co-chairman  
Ralph Ahringer  
George Grimstad  
Robert E. Hitchins  
Robert Macpherson  
Paula Carpenter  
John Rae  
Robert Roy  
Mary E. Sullivan  
Janet Graves  
Barry Leach  
Ann McFarlane, secretary

### POLICY

Bill Coogan, Chairman  
Tom W. Moore, co-chairman  
Donald G. Austin  
John D. Bealer, M.D.  
Travis Dancy, M.D.  
Vincent Dole, M.D.  
Donald Farrell  
George N. Gordon  
Tom Grafton  
George Grimstad  
Jim Hiers  
Robert E. Hitchins  
Ann Macfarlane  
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.  
Jack R. Meagher  
Stephen Owen, Sr.  
John Rae  
Robert Roy  
Midge McLadden, secretary

### PUBLIC INFORMATION

Walter Murphy, Chairman  
Jack Morley  
Virginia Mailman  
Jerry Danzig  
John Henderson  
Rex Moody  
Janet Graves  
Colin MacLachlan  
Mary Ellen Uribe, secretary

### NOMINATING

Robert Pearson, Chairman  
Donald Farrell, co-chairman  
Ralph Ahringer  
Bill Coogan  
Travis Dancy, M.D.  
Robert E. Hitchins  
Austin MacCormick  
Tom W. Moore  
Walter Murphy  
Robert Roy  
Valerie Seyffert, secretary

### PROFESSIONAL RELATIONS

Stephen Owen, Sr., Chairman  
Jim Hiers  
Robert E. Hitchins  
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.  
Robert Macpherson

William Plunkert  
John Rae  
Donald G. Austin  
Rev. Yvelin Gardner  
Cora Louise Belford, secretary

### LONG-RANGE PLANNING

John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman  
Margaret Carlson  
Robert E. Hitchins

Robert McAteer  
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.  
Robert Pearson

# 1972 Conference Committees

## Agenda-Admissions

\*Bryon Barnes, E. Missouri  
Richard Harter, N. Indiana  
Shorty Hofstedt, Washington  
Robert McAteer, W. Virginia

John Deal, Georgia

\*\*Louis Dietrich, No. Illinois  
Richard Driscoll, W. Mass.  
Frank Juola, No. Minnesota  
Guy Kelley, Alaska

### *Ex-Officio*

Betty Vaughan, Oregon

*Secretary:* Waneta New

## Conference Report & Charter

Joe Cawley, Chicago, Illinois  
C. W. Gilbert, Arkansas  
Ed MacDonald, N.S./Nfld./Lab.  
Lenore Marple, E. Pennsylvania  
Dick Toussaint, Nevada  
Bill Valli, B.C./Yukon

Chet Carlson, Oregon

\*\*Don Owens, So. Indiana  
Criss Richards, Kentucky  
Ralph Zimmerman, W. New York

*Secretary:* Nell Wing

## Finance

Jack Crenshaw, Alabama  
Adam Holzhauser, So. Illinois  
Warren McGinley, So. Minnesota  
John L. Nolan, Colorado✓  
William Rennie, Connecticut

Gordon Brooks, New Hampshire  
Lloyd Gardner, South Carolina

\*\*Jim Hoey, Alberta  
Stan Masson, Wyoming

### *Ex-Officio*

Hal Cornelius, San Diego, Calif.

*Secretary:* Dennis Manders

## Grapevine

Bob Allen, Hawaii  
William Baker, No. New Jersey  
Hank Burgess, Iowa  
Dr. Mel LeGard, E. Ontario  
\*Zeb Mauney, North Carolina

Bob Bernelle, No. Interior Calif.  
\*\*George Derksen, Saskatchewan  
Earl Lindsey, Tennessee  
Ben Parr, Kansas  
Howard Shortsleeves, Vermont

*Secretary:* Paula Carpenter

## Institutions

Bob Buck, W. Pennsylvania  
Gloria Carter, Louisiana  
George Stewart, Utah  
Shirley Susevich, N.E. Ohio  
Gus Wright, W. Missouri

\*\*Red Dillon, Arizona  
Bob Gay, N.B./P.E.I.  
Jim O'Neill, New Mexico✓  
Tom Walker, So. New Jersey

### *Ex Officio*

Floyd D'Arcy, W. Michigan  
Cecil Hamilton, South Carolina  
Chuck Luke, South Dakota  
Ellery Stowell, Mid-Southern Calif.

*Secretary:* Phyllis MacDonald

## Literature

Jim Allen, No. Coastal Calif.  
William Armstrong, Jr., N.E. Texas  
Ken Church, S.E. Michigan  
Howard Robinson, Central & S.E. Ohio  
John E. Ryall, S.E. New York

Marvin Barkley, South Dakota  
Ted Bowen, Idaho  
\*Dunc McArthur, Western Ontario  
\*Roland Rivard, Maine  
\*\*Henry Watson, Mississippi

### *Ex Officio*

Margaret Carlson, W. Mass.

*Secretary:* Ann Macfarlane

## Conference Policy

Patricia Glenn, So. Florida  
Neil Matlock, S.E. Texas  
Jack Brownyard, Central New York  
Hector Lavictoire, N.E. Ontario

Charles Barlow, San Diego, Calif.  
William Clapp, Maryland  
\*\*Archie MacKay, W. Michigan  
Zandos Rodriguez, Puerto Rico  
Robert Stellen, Montana

*Secretary:* Midge McFadden

## Professional Relations

\*\*LaVelle Clifford, Northwestern Texas  
Swan Johnson, Rhode Island  
Wilbert Laaninen, No. Wisconsin/  
Upper Michigan  
John McAneny, Mid-Southern Calif.  
Elmer Signori, S.W. Quebec (French)

*Secretary:* Cora Louise Belford

## Public Information

Carl Binam, So. California  
Sam Inman, No. Florida  
Hal Marley, Washington, D.C.  
George McMullen, Central Michigan  
Barry Weiss, Northwestern Ontario

Dennett Hutchinson, North Dakota  
\*\*Sheila Martin, S.W. Quebec (English)  
Mary Tomlinson, HMB/New York  
Ken Wilkerson, So. S.W. Ohio/No. Ken.

### *Ex Officio*

Clarence Berg, No. Minnesota

*Secretary:* Mary Ellen Uribe

## Conference Committee on Trustees

Joseph Bach, So. Wisconsin  
Stuart Nelson, E. Massachusetts  
Joe Bristow, Virginia  
Earl Paquet, N.E. Quebec  
Jim Dambold, Oklahoma✓

Bill Heatley, Manitoba  
\*\*Carl Kumpf, Delaware  
Doug Mills, Nebraska  
Elves Smith, S.W. Texas  
Jim Williams, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan

### *Ex Officio*

Jimmy Dodson, New Mexico  
Joe Fitzpatrick, Rhode Island

*Secretary:* Valerie Seyffert

\*Alternate Delegate

\*\*Chairman

# 1972 Conference Area Delegates

| STATE                  | PANEL |                                                                                     | STATE         | PANEL                                                                                        |
|------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA | (21)  | Jack Crenshaw, Washington Bldg., Montgomery, Alabama 36104                          |               |                                                                                              |
| ALASKA                 | (22)  | Guy Kelley, 2807½ W. 30th, Anchorage, Alaska 99503                                  |               |                                                                                              |
| ARIZONA                | (22)  | Red Dillon, 157 E. Tremaine Drive, Chandler, Arizona 85224                          |               |                                                                                              |
| ARKANSAS               | (21)  | C.W. Gilbert, 113 W. 12th Street, Dewitt, Arkansas 72042                            | INDIANA       | (21) Southern - Adam Holzhauer, 201 North Penfield, Rantoul, Illinois 61866                  |
| CALIFORNIA             | (21)  | Southern - Carl V. Binam, 3490 Hadley Way, Santa Maria, California 93454            |               | (21) Northern - Richard Harter, 201 Red River Road, New Castle, Indiana 47362                |
|                        | (21)  | Northern Coastal - Jim Allen, 134½ Nevada Street, San Francisco, California 94110   |               | (22) Southern - Don Owens, 2201 South 8th Street, Terre Haute, Indiana 47802                 |
|                        | (22)  | Northern Interior - Bob Bernelle, 3701 Irish Road, Redding, Ca. 96001               | IOWA          | (21) Henry Burgess, 1340 W. Ridgeway Avenue, Waterloo, Iowa 50701                            |
|                        | (22)  | San Diego - Charles Barlow, 1820 Denver Street, San Diego, Ca. 92110                | KANSAS        | (22) Ben Parr, Route 1, Pratt, Kansas 67124                                                  |
|                        | (22)  | Mid-Southern - John McAneny, 447 Fair Drive, Apt. 104, Costa Mesa, California 92626 | KENTUCKY      | (22) Criss B. Richards, 7816 Dixie Highway, Florence, Kentucky 41042                         |
| COLORADO               | (21)  | John Nolan, 406 McKinley, Sterling, Colorado 80751                                  | LOUISIANA     | (21) Gloria Carter, 115 Meadow Lane, Lafayette, Louisiana 70501                              |
| CONNECTICUT            | (21)  | William Rennie, 95 Fitch Street, North Haven, Connecticut 06473                     | MAINE         | (22) *Roland Rivard, 541 Somerset Street, Rumford, Maine 04276                               |
| DELAWARE               | (22)  | Carl D. Kumpf, R.D. #1, Box 219-A, West Grove, Pennsylvania 19391                   | MARYLAND      | (22) William Clapp, 106 Lorraine Terrace, Hagerstown, Maryland 21740                         |
| D.C.                   | (21)  | Hal Marley, 5111 8th Road South, Arlington, Virginia 22204                          | MASSACHUSETTS | (21) Eastern - A. Stuart Nelson, 293 North Elm Street, West Bridgewater, Massachusetts 02379 |
| FLORIDA                | (21)  | Northern - Sam Inman, 7703 Hare Avenue, Jacksonville, Florida 32211                 |               | (22) Western - Richard Driscoll, 129 Rhinebeck Avenue, Springfield, Massachusetts 01129      |
|                        | (21)  | Southern - Patricia Glenn, Box 1031, Bradenton, Florida 33505                       | MICHIGAN      | (21) Central - George McMullen, 1315 Hayes Street, Saginaw, Mi. 48602                        |
| GEORGIA                | (22)  | John Deal, 333 Jewel Drive, Statesboro, Georgia 30458                               |               | (21) Southeast - Ken Church, 23718 Wilmot - East Detroit, Mi. 48021                          |
| HAWAII                 | (21)  | Bob Allen, Apt. 12-A Regency, 4340 Pahoa Avenue, Honolulu, Hawaii 96816             |               | (22) Western - Archie MacKay, 3802 Camelot Drive S.E., Grand Rapids Michigan 49506           |
| IDAHO                  | (22)  | Ted Bowen, Box 3, Malad, Idaho 83252                                                | MINNESOTA     | (22) Northern - Frank Juola, 312 16th Street, Cloquet, Minnesota 55720                       |
| ILLINOIS               | (21)  | Chicago - Joe Cawley, 7616 Vine, River Forest, Illinois 60305                       |               | (21) Southern - Warren McGinley, 1073 Hague Avenue, St. Paul, Minnesota 55104                |
|                        | (22)  | Northern - Louis W. Dietrich, Box 591, Glen Ellyn, Illinois 60137                   | MISSISSIPPI   | (22) Henry Watson, Box 46, Aberdeen, Mississippi 39730                                       |

*What Do Panel Numbers Mean?* Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 22nd Conference is made up of Panel 21 -- the odd delegates -- and Panel 22 -- the new delegates.

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## Delegates, cont'd

| STATE          | PANEL                                                                                          | STATE          | PANEL                                                                                             |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MISSOURI       | (21) *Eastern - Byron Barnes, 7 E. 9th Street, Fulton, Missouri 65251                          | OKLAHOMA       | (21) Jim Dambold, P.O. Box 248, Lawton, Oklahoma 73501                                            |
|                | (21) Western - Gus Wright, 8911 East 67th Street, Apt. 119, Kansas City, Missouri 64133        | OREGON         | (22) Chet Carlson, 23349 S. Molalla Ave., Oregon City, Oregon 97045                               |
| MONTANA        | (22) Robert Steilen, Box 121, Pablo, Montana 59855                                             | PENNSYLVANIA   | (21) Eastern - Lenore Marple, 1582 Springhill Drive, Springhill Farms, Aston, Pennsylvania 19014  |
| NEBRASKA       | (22) Doug Mills, Jr., Rt. #1, Ansley, Nebraska 68814                                           |                | (21) Western - Bob Buck, 4116 Page St., Erie, Pennsylvania 16510                                  |
| NEVADA         | (21) Dick Toussaint, 635 Pecos Way, Las Vegas, Nevada 89109                                    | RHODE ISLAND   | (22) Swan Johnson, 158 Massasoit Drive, Warwick, Rhode Island 02888                               |
| NEW HAMPSHIRE  | (22) Gordon Brooks, 18 Briar Road, Bedford, New Hampshire 03102                                | SOUTH CAROLINA | (22) Lloyd Gardner, 143 Cleveland Park Drive, Spartanburg, S.C. 29302                             |
| NEW JERSEY     | (21) Northern - William Baker, 215 Clinton Place, Hackensack, New Jersey 07602                 | SOUTH DAKOTA   | (22) Marvin Barkley, 717 North, Watertown, South Dakota 57201                                     |
|                | (22) Southern - Thomas Walker, Box 95, Lumberton, New Jersey 08048                             | TENNESSEE      | (22) Earl Lindsey, 3775 Westview Drive, Cleveland, Tennessee 37311                                |
| NEW MEXICO     | (22) James O'Neill, P.O. Box 154, Farmington, New Mexico 87401                                 | TEXAS          | (21) Northeast - William G. Armstrong, Jr., P.O. Box 295, Gainesville, Texas 76240                |
| NEW YORK       | (21) Central - Jack Brownyard, 2220 Main Street E., Rochester, New York 14609                  |                | (22) Northwest - LaVelle Clifford, 200 Shadow Mountain Drive, No. 97, El Paso, Texas 79912        |
|                | (22) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire - Mary Tomlinson, P.O. Box 23, Monroe Bridge, Massachusetts 01350 |                | (21) Southeast - Neil Matlock, 3522 Ave. "L", Galveston, Texas 77550                              |
|                | (21) Southeastern - John E. Ryall, 32 Garden Avenue, Carle Place, New York 11514               |                | (22) Southwest - Elves Smith, 923 Schley Avenue, San Antonio, Texas 78210                         |
|                | (22) Western - Ralph Zimmerman, 5239 River Road, Niagara Falls, Ontario, Canada                | UTAH           | (21) George Stewart, 2467 Beverly St., Salt Lake City, Utah 84106                                 |
| NORTH CAROLINA | (21) *Zeb Mauney, P.O. Box 306, Newport, North Carolina 28570                                  | VERMONT        | (22) Howard Shortsleeves, 72 Pine Street, Rutland, Vermont 05701                                  |
| NORTH DAKOTA   | (22) Dennett Hutchinson, Box 748, Rugby, North Dakota 58368                                    | VIRGINIA       | (21) Joe Bristow, Box 197, Saluda, Virginia 23149                                                 |
| OHIO           | (21) Central & Southeast - Howard Robinson, 904 Adair Avenue, Zanesville, Ohio 43701           | WASHINGTON     | (21) Harold (Shorty) Hofstedt, 105 So. Williams, Kennewick, Wa. 99336                             |
|                | (21) Northeast - Shirley Susevich, 1868 Redbird Road - North Madison, Ohio 44057               | WEST VIRGINIA  | (21) Robert McAteer, 1522 Court Ave., St. Albans, West Virginia 25177                             |
|                | (22) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Michigan - Jim Williams, 5628 McLain Drive, Sylva, Ohio 43560            | WISCONSIN      | (22) No. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan - Wilbert Laaninen, Rt. #1, Box 84B, Republic, Michigan 49879 |
|                | (22) So./Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky - Ken Wilkerson, 4051 Plover, Hamilton, Ohio 45014 |                | (21) Southern - Joseph E. Bach, 2861 North 84th Street, Milwaukee, Wisconsin 53222                |
|                |                                                                                                | WYOMING        | (22) Stan Masson, Box 364, Sinclair, Wyoming 82334                                                |
|                |                                                                                                | PUERTO RICO    | (22) Zandos Rodriguez, W-H-18, URB, Los Angeles, Loiza Sta., Santurce, Puerto Rico                |

## ROSTER

### Delegates, cont'd

#### PROVINCE

#### PANEL

#### CANADA

##### ALBERTA

- (22) Jim Hoey, 11175 Sacramento Dr.,  
S.W. Calgary, Alberta, Canada

##### BRITISH COLUMBIA/ YUKON

- (21) Bill Valli, 2459 Rosewood Avenue,  
Kamloops, B.C., Canada

##### MANITOBA

- (22) Bill Heatley, 49-50 Prevette Place,  
Winnipeg, 15, Manitoba, Canada

##### NEW BRUNSWICK/ PRINCE EDWARD ISL.

- (22) Bob Gay, 20 Donald Ave., Moncton,  
N.B., Canada

##### NOVA SCOTIA/NEW- FOUNDLAND/ LABRADOR

- (21) Ed P. MacDonald, Room 604, Sir  
Humphrey Gilbert Bldg., St. John's,  
Newfoundland, Canada

##### ONTARIO

- (21) Eastern - Dr. Mel LeGard, 2347  
Weston Road, Weston, Ontario,  
Canada
- (21) Northeastern - Hector Lavictoire,  
52 Marleau Street, Sturgeon Falls,  
Ontario, Canada

#### PROVINCE

#### PANEL

- (21) Northwestern - Barry Weiss, 420  
Heather Crescent, Station F, Thun-  
der Bay, Ontario, Canada

- (22) \*Western - Dunc McArthur, 337  
Dunlop Crescent, Burlington, Ont.,  
Canada

#### QUEBEC

- (22) Southwestern - English - Sheila  
Martin, 8 Church Street, Point Claire,  
Quebec, Canada

- (22) Southwestern - French - Elmer  
Signori, 8357 Rameau, Montreal  
429, Quebec, Canada

- (21) Northeast - Earl Paquet, 611 Rue  
Oustedt, Arvida, Quebec, Canada

#### SASKATCHEWAN

- (22) George Derksen, 820 Hastings Place,  
Estevan, Saskatchewan, Canada

*\*ALTERNATE DELEGATE*